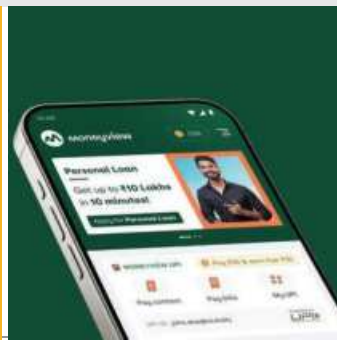


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Long view.
Debt mutual funds ace the inflation test across cycles
BIG STORY P2



IPO Watch.
Should you subscribe to the Moneyview offer?
TAKING STOCK P5

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New-age IPOs: Five years on, still show-me stories

RICH BET. While many companies have scaled revenue and achieved break-even, investors are paying ₹260 for every ₹1 of profit earned by these firms

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

“Show me the money,” the memorable line from Tom Cruise-starrer *Jerry Maguire*, could well be the market’s refrain for India’s new-age IPOs five years on. Back in 2021, when a clutch of these companies hit the stock market, investors were asked to look beyond losses and conventional valuation metrics. With profits largely absent, revenue growth and EV-to-sales multiples became the preferred yardsticks.

Half a decade later, the picture is more nuanced. Many of these companies have delivered strong revenue growth, several have turned profitable, and a few have handsomely outperformed the market. Yet, valuations remain demanding, while reported profits at many firms continue to receive significant support from ‘other income’, and core operating profitability is still evolving. The original question, therefore, has not disappeared; it has simply changed. Can operating profits grow enough to justify the valuations investors continue to assign?

GROWTH DELIVERED

The strongest argument in favour of the 2021 new-age IPO cohort is that several companies have largely delivered on growth expectations.

Eternal, formerly Zomato, has seen total income surge to ₹55,760 crore in FY26, translating into a four-year CAGR of over 80 per cent. Its adjusted EBITDA margin has improved sharply, from minus 44 per cent in FY22 to 2.2 per cent in FY26. The stock has risen about 341 per cent from its IPO price, far ahead of the 47 per cent gain in the Nifty 50 TRI over the same period.

PB Fintech has grown total income at a CAGR of 46.6 per cent between FY22 and FY26, while its EBITDA margin improved from minus 64.9 per cent to 6.9 per cent. RateGain Travel Technologies recorded a total income CAGR of 48.9 per cent and expanded EBITDA margins from 8.7 per cent to 18.5 per cent.

Nazara Technologies delivered topline growth of 47.9 per cent annually, while Nykaa grew at 27.5 per cent. CarTrade Tech, meanwhile, swung from an EBITDA margin of minus 42.9 per cent in FY22 to 33 per cent in FY26.

The stock-market scorecard, too, is not uniformly disappointing. Eternal, Nazara, RateGain, CarTrade and Nykaa have outperformed the Nifty 50 TRI since their IPOs, while Easy Trip, One97 Communications (Paytm) and CE Info Systems (MapMyIndia) have lagged.

THE CORE PROFIT TEST

That said, the conversation around

Still paying for tomorrow

Company	Absolute stock price change from respective IPO offer price (%)	*FY22 EBITDA margin (%)	*FY26 EBITDA margin (%)	*FY26 P/E
Easy Trip Planners	1.3	56.3	-2.8	NA#
Nazara Technologies	173.5	15.2	13.9	105.5
RateGain Travel Tech.	94.8	8.7	18.5	49.6
Eternal (Zomato)	340.8	-44.0	2.2	572.5
CarTrade Tech	85.6	-42.9	33.0	35.3
FSN E-commerce (Nykaa)	78.0	4.3	7.5	335.7
PB Fintech (Policybazaar)	19.0	-64.9	6.9	97.9
One 97 (Paytm)	-22.1	-47.0	8.4	110.7
CE Info Systems (MapMyIndia)	-14.6	43.0	37.0	32.6

Source: Bloomberg, Capitaline, BSE. *On an adjusted basis; # Reported losses in FY26

these companies remains centred on revenue growth and EBITDA, much as it was at the time of listing. Even after five years, the focus has not fully shifted to robust operating profits.

The tougher test now is whether these businesses have converted scale into durable and meaningful profitability. On that score, the picture remains mixed.

Eternal reported a FY26 net profit of ₹366 crore on revenue of ₹55,760 crore. However, its other income stood at ₹1,396 crore, nearly four times its reported net profit. While operating profitability has improved substantially, an EBITDA margin of 2.2 per cent remains modest relative to the expectations embedded in the stock.

PB Fintech reported a FY26 net profit of ₹670 crore, compared with a loss of ₹833 crore in FY22.

Yet, other income of ₹372 crore accounted for about 56 per cent of net profit. With proposed insurance distribution reforms likely to weigh on earnings, profitability expectations for FY28 already appear under pressure, with recovery potentially pushed to FY29. The ₹33,000-crore erosion in market capitalisation of the stock over just two trading sessions recently underscored the risks of valuations driven more by future expectations than current cash flows.

Paytm presents an even starker contrast. It reported a FY26 net profit of ₹552 crore, while other income amounted to ₹854 crore. The composition of earnings, therefore, matters as much as the headline turnaround from losses to profits.

To be sure, other income does not automatically imply poor earnings quality. It can include legitimate treasury income, fair-value gains, forex gains, provision write-backs and other non-operating items. Cash-rich companies can justifiably earn substantial income from surplus funds. However, when judging whether these businesses have matured enough to support premium valuations, investors must distinguish profits generated by the core franchise from those arising from non-operating sources.

There are, however, stronger operating performers within the cohort. RateGain’s FY26 EBITDA margin of 18.5 per cent, CarTrade’s 33 per cent and CE Info Systems’ 37 per cent suggest that some companies have begun to demonstrate meaningful operating leverage.

VALUATIONS STILL PRICEY

The larger issue is that valuations continue to price in substantial future growth. Collectively, these nine companies generated about ₹2,400 crore in net profit in FY26 but command a combined market capitalisation of more than ₹6.25 lakh crore. In effect, investors are paying roughly ₹260 for every ₹1 of profit generated by these firms. By comparison, investors pay only about ₹28 for every rupee earned by an old-economy company such as Larsen & Toubro.

Bloomberg data based on FY26 earnings show Eternal trading at

about 572 times earnings, Nykaa at 336 times, Paytm at 111 times, Nazara at 105 times and PB Fintech at around 98 times. Their EV/EBITDA multiples are equally demanding, with Eternal at 172 times, PB Fintech at 126 times and Nykaa at 91 times.

By contrast, the relatively mature operating profiles of RateGain, CarTrade and CE Info Systems are accompanied by lower, though hardly inexpensive, valuation multiples. RateGain trades at about 50 times FY26 earnings, even as several leading global SaaS companies trade at single-digit or low-teens P/E multiples. CarTrade trades at 35 times earnings, while CE Info Systems is valued at about 33 times earnings and 23 times EV/EBITDA. Even then, CE Info Systems’ stock remains nearly 15 per cent below its IPO price.

Overall, the burden of proof remains high for the most richly valued names. Five years ago, investors were asked to look beyond losses and pay for future growth. Today, growth is visible and profits have begun to emerge. Yet current valuations still assume another significant leg of margin expansion and earnings growth. For many of these companies, therefore, the story remains very much a show-me one. Sooner rather than later, investors are likely to demand sustained and meaningful operating profits, not just topline growth.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Invesco India Large Cap Fund: Invest

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Investors seeking an actively managed large-cap fund with a five-to-seven-year horizon can consider Invesco India Large Cap Fund.

The 5-star-rated *bl.portfolio* Star Track Ratings offering has delivered strong and consistent performance across holding periods, ranking second among its peers in three-, five-, seven- and 10-year SIP returns. Its rolling-return record is equally encouraging, with minimum three- and five-year returns of 10.4 per cent and 9.5 per cent, respectively.

The fund also makes greater use of its flexibility to invest beyond large-caps, with 8.4 per cent of the portfolio currently allocated to small-caps, compared with about 2 per cent for the large-cap fund category. It has also made efficient use of the risks taken, with its risk-adjusted performance among the best in the category.

Details p4

10%+ growth reachable with reforms, start-up innovations, says FM Nirmala Sitharaman

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



Nirmala Sitharaman at the 7th edition of the IITMAA Sangam 2026 in Bengaluru PTI

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Saturday said India should target GDP growth of over 10 per cent, asserting that the milestone is within reach if the country sustains its pace of reforms and innovation led by start-ups.

Speaking at a fireside chat organised by the IIT Madras Alumni Association in Bengaluru, Sitharaman was responding to a question on how India could accelerate growth beyond its current trajectory.

The economy has grown at an average of 7.6 per cent over the past six years despite disruptions from the pandemic and the Ukraine war, with 7.8 per cent growth in the most recent year. “It is possible to reach 10 plus growth. And I’m not just saying it to pep you all up. It is possible,” Sitharaman said.

“One would have wanted to postpone the decision to hike prices given the upcoming festival period, but the cost pressures due to higher commodity and crude derivative prices and volatility in exchange rates have intensified,” he said.

GROWTH ENGINES

Sitharaman pointed to the start-up ecosystem as evidence of the momentum needed to

push growth higher. She said the sector’s contribution to the economy has scaled sharply since 2015 and could rival that of established industries in the coming years.

She cited space technology start-ups, which have moved from a negligible presence to building satellites and other systems for global clients. The growth, she said, reflected the ability of Indian companies to develop cost-effective and efficient technologies.

Sitharaman also cited agriculture as a sector being reshaped by startup-driven technology, from market-linkage platforms to drone-based land mapping and precision applications.

“Rapid movement of technology, the innovations which happen in start-ups will have to

get into every sector,” she said, stressing that such interventions would need to scale across the economy for growth to accelerate.

AI ECOSYSTEM

On artificial intelligence, Sitharaman pushed back against the perception that India has fallen behind, saying the scale of the country’s AI ecosystem was not fully visible because relatively few AI companies have entered the public markets.

She said India already has AI Unicorns and several companies approaching that status, but their limited presence on domestic exchanges meant the sector was under-represented in assessments based on listed companies.

Also read p12

Reuters
Shanghai



A file photo of US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping during the latter’s visit to the US REUTERS

China said on Saturday it had agreed with the US on a \$30 billion reciprocal tariff-reduction arrangement and on launching a dialogue on AI, under an eight-point consensus reached during President Xi Jinping’s visit to Washington.

The two sides also agreed to set up a trade council and extend the outcomes of earlier talks in Kuala Lumpur, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said.

The agreement follows an earlier move by the world’s two largest economies to extend by two months a trade truce that was due to expire on November 10, allowing more time to work on a potentially bigger trade deal, US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent had said.

“This historic visit enriched the constructive and stable China-US relationship, upheld the overall stability of bilateral ties, opened a new chapter in China-US relations, and will have a far-reaching impact on world peace and development,” Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi said in a statement.

AI COMMUNICATION LINES

On Artificial Intelligence, the two sides agreed to hold a dialogue on the technology’s risks and benefits, with the next round of discussions set for November, and to set up a communication channel for AI-related incidents, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said.

The Ministry also said in a separate statement that Beijing valued Washington’s use of the term “super intelligence” in place of “artificial intelligence”. As the AI technology continues to advance, the two sides should step up exchanges and work towards consensus, in line with new developments, it said.

Pricey inputs: AC to cost 5-8% more from Oct 1; hikes coming for TV, washing machine, fridge, too

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Leading consumer durable makers are set to raise air-conditioner prices by 5-8 per cent from October 1, ahead of the peak festival buying season. Some companies will also increase prices of LED TVs, washing machines and refrigerators, while others are evaluating the timing of hikes in these categories.

Companies cited sustained increases in key raw material costs, including copper, steel and aluminium, along with higher crude derivatives and adverse currency movements. While some industry players expect the latest round of price hikes to weigh on consumer sentiment, others said early stocking by retailers could shield consumers from the full impact during the festival season.

NS Satish, CEO, Haier Appliances India, said the company is raising AC prices by 5 per cent, while prices of other categories, including LED TVs, washing machines and refrigerators, will go up by 3-4 per cent.

“One would have wanted to postpone the decision to hike prices given the upcoming festival period, but the cost pressures due to higher commodity and crude derivative prices and volatility in exchange rates have intensified,” he said.

AC PRICES TO RISE

According to sources, LG Electronics India has told trade partners that prices of its AC portfolio will increase by 5-7 per cent from October 1. It has not announced any decision on other product categories.

Volta also informed trade partners that it is raising room AC prices by 5-7 per cent, citing a challenging cost environment. Blue Star MD B Thiagarajan confirmed



that the company will hike prices by 5-8 per cent from October 1.

The consumer durables sector has taken more than one round of price increases since January, amid cost pressures triggered by the West Asia conflict.

Kamal Nandi, Business Head and EVP-Appliances Business, Godrej Enterprises Group, said commodity costs had hardened further, with inflation of 8-10 per cent since the last price hike.

“Hence, an industry-wide price hike of 5-7 per cent across categories is inevitable,” he said, adding that the

company was evaluating the timing and that hikes in some categories would take effect from October 1.

However, consumers will at least have the festive window to purchase at the old price as retailers have pipeline of stocks for about a month, Nandi said.

TV PRICES MAY JUMP

LED TV makers such as SPPL and Videotex are also raising prices, citing higher memory chip and freight costs.

Avneet Singh Marwah, CEO, SPPL, said the company plans to raise prices by 10 per cent in October.

Arjun Bajaj, Director, Videotex, said prices of LED TVs in smaller screen sizes could rise by up to 20 per cent, while larger screen sizes could see increases of up to 10 per cent. “Consumers are likely to see a new base price for consumer electronics after Diwali,” Bajaj said.

SME IPO market revives despite dull listing gains

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The SME IPO market is showing renewed activity, with the number of companies tapping NSE Emerge and BSE SME nearly doubling in September, even as tighter regulations, valuation concerns and muted listing gains are forcing investors to look beyond first-day returns.

Forty-three companies raised ₹1,702 crore through SME IPOs in September, compared with 23 that mobilised ₹1,156 crore in August, according to data sourced from Steptrade Capital, an Alternative Investment Fund specialising in SME and micro-cap investments.

In the first nine months of 2026, about 170 small companies raised more than ₹7,500 crore against 173 SME IPOs that mopped up around ₹8,200 crore in the year-ago period.

Puneet Singhanian, Whole-time Director, Master Cap-

Investors turn choosy

	Funds raised Jan-Sept 2026 (₹ cr)	Funds raised Jan-Sept 2025 (₹ cr)	No. of issues Jan-Sept 2026	No. of issues Jan-Sept 2025
January	865	880	19	20
February	619	923	14	20
March	387	560	9	15
April	204	85	4	4
May	751	587	17	13
June	941	1,102	24	22
July	891	850	17	18
August	1,156	1,550	23	24
September	1,702	1,700	43	38
Total	7,515	8,237	170	173

Source: Steptrade Capital

ital Services, said exchanges have raised the bar to curb speculation, tightening entry norms as enthusiasm for riskier SME issues grew and setting stricter size and profitability tests for companies seeking to move up to the mainboard.

RETAIL INTEREST

Kresha Gupta, Director and Fund Manager, Steptrade Capital, said investors continue to be attracted to SME IPOs by the opportunity to participate in businesses at

an early stage of their listed journey. Retail liquidity has also increasingly moved towards primary markets. Investors sold shares worth ₹5,674 crore in the secondary market during July and August, while putting around ₹12,618 crore into IPOs, Gupta said.

The SME platform is also continuing to provide a pathway for companies to graduate to the mainboard. Nearly 31 companies migrated to the mainboard in 2026, compared with 30 in

2025, despite stringent eligibility requirements on both exchanges, Gupta said.

Pankaj Agrawal, Director, Valmiki Leela Capital, said 23 of the 30 SME IPOs listed earlier this year opened below their issue price, while the average listing gain was only around 3 per cent.

“The focus is gradually moving beyond listing-day gains to the company’s valuation, earnings and growth potential,” Agrawal said.

Anchor investments in SME IPOs rose from about ₹131 crore in FY23 to ₹2,204 crore in FY25, although mutual funds have remained selective because of smaller issue sizes and limited liquidity in several SME stocks.

BEYOND FUND-RAISING

Bipin Bhanushali, President, Investment Banking, Marwadi Chandarana Group, said SMEs are increasingly viewing IPOs not merely as a fund-raising exercise but as a platform to support expansion and improve market visibility.

bl.portfolio

DEBT FUNDS ACE THE INFLATION TEST

LONG VIEW. Across market cycles, debt schemes have largely preserved purchasing power, with outcomes varying by category and inflation regime

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

Debt mutual funds are rarely sold as inflation beaters. Yet, over long holding periods, that is largely what they have been. A *bl.portfolio* analysis of 130 schemes across 11 debt fund categories shows that 89 per cent of seven-year rolling-return observations and 83 per cent of five-year observations beat consumer price inflation.

The finding is particularly relevant at a time when traditional fixed-income products have themselves held up surprisingly well against equities over recent three- and five-year periods. Equities, often considered the default inflation-beating asset, have faced a reality check in recent years.

As highlighted in *The Great Indian Bull Market Paradox* (*bl.portfolio* edition dated September 20) (<https://tinyurl.com/358y83bt>), even the humble SBI FD and Post Office Time Deposits have outpaced the Nifty 50 and many domestic stocks over the last three years.

We tested whether debt funds' real-return advantage holds across categories, holding periods and inflation regimes.

Here are the insights.

WHAT WE ANALYSED

Before we go into details, readers should know that our analysis covers 130 schemes across 11 debt fund categories that predominantly invest in securities with maturities beyond one year: Banking & PSU Debt, Corporate Bond, Credit Risk, Dynamic Bond, Floating Rate, Gilt, Gilt with 10-year Constant Maturity, Long Term, Medium Term, Medium-to-

Long Term and Short Term funds.

Scheme returns were compared with the All-India Combined Consumer Price Index (CPI), the inflation measure used by the RBI in its monetary policy framework. Since monthly data for the CPI series is available from January 2011, the analysis goes back up to 15 years. The CPI series has been adjusted using MoSPI's linking factors to ensure consistency across its three base-year revisions.

We examined both point-to-point and rolling returns. Over the 15 years ended August 2026, CPI inflation compounded at 5.5 per cent annually. The corresponding annualised inflation rates were 4.6 per cent over 10 years, 4.9 per cent over five years, 3.5 per cent over three years and 4.82 per cent over one year.

For a more consistent test across different entry points, we also calculated one-, three-, five- and seven-year rolling returns at monthly intervals. This analysis was restricted to the last 10 years, given the availability of schemes with sufficiently long track records.

KEY FINDINGS

Our analysis throws up six broad takeaways on how debt funds have fared against inflation across time periods, categories and market conditions.

Longer horizons improve the odds of beating inflation

The point-to-point analysis of debt-fund returns against CPI (Table 1) shows a clear pattern: Longer holding periods generally improved the likelihood of beating inflation. Across all 130 schemes, only 46 per cent beat CPI over the one-year period. The proportion jumped to 88 per cent over two years and reached 100 per cent over three years. It moderated to 83 per cent over

five years, before rising to 98 per cent over both the 10- and 15-year periods.

The weak one-year showing is instructive. Debt fund returns can be affected in the short term by movements in interest rates and credit spreads. Over longer periods, however, there was a marked improvement—Corporate Bond, Floating Rate, Short Term and several duration-oriented categories saw virtually all schemes beat CPI over the 10- and 15-year periods.

The point-to-point evidence, therefore, suggests that debt funds are far less dependable as inflation-beaters over short periods, while the odds of earning positive real returns improve materially as the holding period lengthens.

Rolling returns show greater consistency

Point-to-point snapshots can be sensitive to the chosen start and end dates. In this analysis, the period ends in August 2026, when CPI inflation was 4.82 per cent, relatively moderate compared with some earlier periods.

Rolling-return analysis helps reduce this dependence on a single start and end point. Using monthly observations over a 10-year window, with a minimum track-record filter, the adjacent chart shows that the share of observations beating CPI rises steadily from 70 per cent for one-year rolling returns to 89 per cent for seven-year rolling returns.

This consistency is notable because the decade under review included multiple interest-rate cycles, Covid-era disruptions, record-low interest rates, aggressive post-pandemic tightening and elevated inflation. Despite these swings, debt funds generated positive real returns in the majority of medium- and long-term observations.

Category choice matters

The category-level rolling analysis reveals meaningful differences (Table 2). Banking & PSU Debt funds were among the most consistent performers, with around 96 per cent of five-year observations and 100 per cent of seven-year observations beating inflation.

Floating Rate funds and Gilt funds with 10-year Constant Maturity also performed consistently, with all seven-year periods generating positive real returns.

At the other end, Medium-to-Long Term and Credit Risk funds showed lower consistency. Even in these categories, however, the proportion of inflation-beating observations improved significantly as the investment horizon lengthened.

The differences underline why debt funds cannot be treated as a homogeneous asset class. Gilt and Longer-Term funds are more sensitive to movements in interest rates, while Credit Risk funds carry greater credit-related risks. Short Term funds, by contrast, are generally less sensitive to large interest rate moves. These differences affect both the consistency and the timing of inflation-adjusted returns.

The margin over inflation

Beating inflation is one thing; beating it by a meaningful margin is another. The five-year rolling analysis shows that, in most categories, the excess return over CPI was positive but modest (Table 3).

The largest share of observations generally fell in the 1-3 percentage-point range above inflation. For Banking & PSU Debt funds, about 57 per cent of observations were in this band. Corporate Bond funds showed a similar pattern, while Floating Rate funds stood out, with nearly 70 per cent of observa-

WISE WORDS.

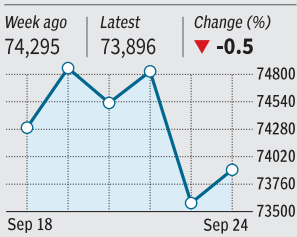
“The only two variables that matter right now are the oil prices and the 10-year yield (US), neither of which are predictable, and both of which move the markets

STEVE EISMAN

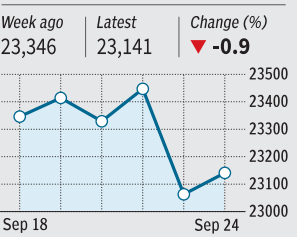
One of the 'Big Short' investors

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



Longer holding periods improved the odds of beating inflation

Share of schemes that outperformed CPI across point-to-point holding periods (%)

Table: 1

Category	1 year	2 years	3 years	5 years	10 years	15 years
Banking and PSU debt fund	55	100	100	100	100	86
Corporate bond	52	100	100	100	100	100
Credit risk fund	92	100	100	100	91	100
Dynamic term	36	82	100	68	100	100
Floating interest rates	100	100	100	100	100	100
Gilt fund	9	57	100	42	100	100
Gilt with 10 year constant maturity	0	100	100	75	100	100
Long term	0	22	100	50	100	100
Medium term	69	100	100	92	92	100
Medium to long term	8	100	100	58	92	92
Short term	67	100	100	100	100	100
Grand total	46	88	100	83	98	98

Returns as of August 31, 2026

How debt-fund categories fare against inflation

Share of rolling observations in which schemes outperformed CPI (%)

Table: 2

Debt fund category	1-year rolling	3-year rolling	5-year rolling	7-year rolling	Based on rolling returns
Banking & PSU debt	76	70	96	100	Rolling returns are calculated for funds with at least 10 years of performance history. Figures show the percentage of schemes whose rolling returns exceeded CPI inflation over the respective holding period
Corporate bond	74	72	94	96	
Credit risk	74	69	69	71	
Dynamic term	65	69	82	94	
Floating interest rates	79	78	95	100	Methodology: Each scheme's return for the respective period was compared with the corresponding-period return of the CPI index. The results were then aggregated and averaged for each category
Gilt	62	69	82	93	
Gilt fund with 10-year constant maturity	70	65	92	100	
Long term	61	64	85	100	
Medium term	73	66	75	76	
Medium to long term	60	61	67	77	
Short term	73	65	84	87	

How far did debt funds stay ahead of inflation

Distribution of five-year rolling observations by excess return over CPI (%)

Table: 3

Category	Fund return below CPI	0-1 percentage point above CPI	1-3 percentage points above CPI	More than 3 percentage points above CPI	Based on rolling returns
Banking and PSU debt fund	4	36	57	3	Methodology: Each scheme's return for every rolling period was compared with the corresponding-period return of the All-India Combined CPI General Index. Instances were classified based on the scheme's return differential versus CPI: below CPI, 0-1 percentage point above CPI, 1-3 percentage points above CPI and more than 3 percentage points above CPI. The figures represent the percentage share of instances in each category, averaged across schemes
Corporate bond	6	32	61	2	
Credit risk fund	14	22	62	2	
Dynamic term	17	40	41	1	
Floating interest rates	5	24	70	1	
Gilt	18	40	40	2	
Gilt with 10 year constant maturity	8	33	46	12	
Long term	15	56	28	2	
Medium term	22	28	49	2	
Medium to long term	31	40	28	0	
Short term	14	43	43	1	

Funds with a consistently higher positive real-return record

Distribution of five-year rolling observations by excess return over CPI (%)

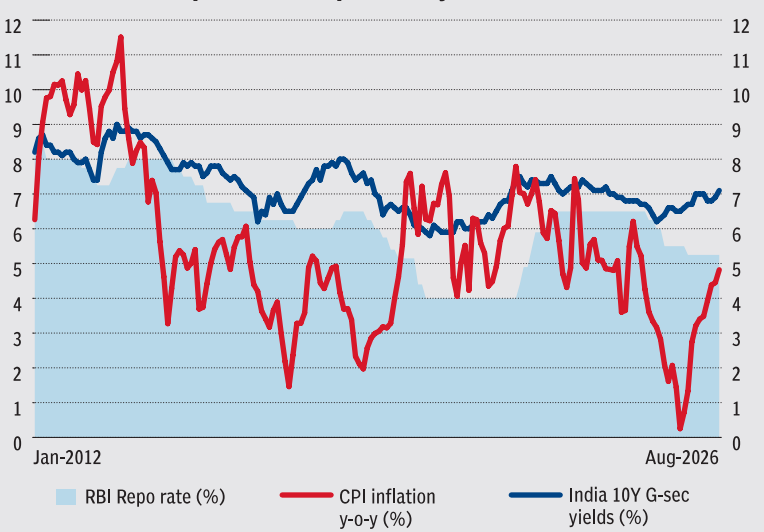
Table: 4

Name	Category	Fund return below CPI	0-1 percentage point above CPI	1-3 percentage points above CPI	More than 3 percentage points above CPI
Edelweiss Banking and PSU Debt	Banking and PSU debt fund	0	7	80	13
Kotak Banking and PSU Debt		0	10	85	5
Aditya Birla SL Corp Bond	Corporate bond	0	0	95	5
ICICI Pru Corp Bond		0	3	93	3
HDFC Corp Bond		0	5	90	5
ICICI Pru Dynamic Term	Dynamic term	0	2	93	5
Nippon India Floating Interest Rates	Floating interest rates	0	8	90	2
ICICI Pru Gilt	Gilt	0	5	92	3
SBI Gilt		0	11	84	5
ICICI Pru 10 year Constant Maturity Gilt	Gilt fund with 10 year constant maturity	0	13	70	16
SBI Medium Term	Medium term	0	0	90	10
ICICI Pru Medium Term		0	0	97	3
HDFC Short Term		0	8	87	5
Aditya Birla SL Short Term	Short term	0	11	87	2

Source: ACEMF, *bl.portfolio* compilation

How inflation affects debt funds

Inflation and repo rates shape bond yields and fund returns



Inflation affects debt fund returns mainly through interest rates and bond yields. When inflation rises sharply, it can prompt the RBI to tighten monetary policy. Higher policy rates and market yields push down the prices of existing bonds, particularly longer-duration securities, hurting debt fund returns in the short term.

For instance, after CPI inflation touched 7.8 per cent in April 2022, the RBI raised the repo rate from 4 per cent to 6.5 per cent over the subsequent tightening cycle. During this period, some gilt funds delivered returns as low as around 2 per cent. Conversely, easing inflation can create room

for lower interest rates, which can push bond prices higher and generate capital gains for debt funds.

Debt fund returns broadly come from coupon accrual and changes in bond prices, driven by movements in interest rates and credit spreads. Rising yields can cause mark-to-market losses initially, but they also allow fresh investments and portfolio reinvestments to earn higher yields.

Over longer periods, coupon accrual and these higher reinvestment yields can help offset some of the initial price decline and improve the potential for positive real returns.

returns and thereby debt funds even with their tax disadvantage have outperformed.

WHAT ALL THIS MEANS

CPI is a useful common benchmark, but it is not an investor's personal inflation rate.

Costs such as education, healthcare and housing can move very differently from headline inflation, so beating CPI does not necessarily mean that a financial goal has been fully protected. Even so, CPI remains a consistent economy-wide yardstick for comparing investment returns over long periods. On that measure, the evidence suggests that debt funds have often delivered positive real returns over longer holding periods, though not uniformly across categories or market conditions.

Despite losing their tax advantage, debt funds can help long-term investors preserve purchasing power. Select Banking & PSU Debt, Corporate Bond, Gilt funds including 10-year Constant Maturity Gilt Funds, have demonstrated inflation-beating potential.

Building wealth together

FINANCIAL PLANNING. A young couple take the first steps towards managing finances and planning for their future

Sridevi V

Yashika, aged 27, wanted to plan her finances. She is married to Sharan and wanted to understand how her finances were to be managed for the common family expenses and her personal expenses.

Her parents gifted Yashika gold jewels and financial assets at the time of her wedding. Sharan and Yashika currently live in a rented 2BHK apartment. Their family expenses are shared 50:50. Sharan has a rental property and pays EMI. He bought the property a couple of years ago, funded equally by his savings and a home loan. His parents gifted him car during their wedding.

Sharan favours real estate and gold as investments. Yashika wants him to close the housing loan and build financial assets.

While Yashika is a personal branding specialist, Sharan is an automobile engineer working in the EV division of an MNC.

Their goals are listed below:

* Buy a car for Yashika next year at an estimated cost of ₹10 lakh

* Closing Sharan's housing loan with an outstanding ₹27 lakh

* Sharan may opt for a six-month online course to develop

Cashflows of the household

	Annual income/ expenses in ₹
Yashika's salary income	18,00,000
Sharan's salary income	16,80,000
Sharan's rental income	1,44,000
Total income	36,24,000
Family expenses, rent	8,00,000
Annual travel	2,00,000
Housing loan repayment	3,84,000
Additional housing loan repayment	6,00,000
Total expenses	19,84,000
Surplus	16,40,000

Couple's net worth

Income	in ₹
Sharan's house	65,00,000
Yashika's equity portfolio	85,00,000
Sharan's EPF	15,00,000
Sharan's mutual funds	4,50,000
Fixed deposits - both	3,00,000
Total	1,72,50,000
Housing loan outstanding	27,00,000
Net worth	1,45,50,000

INSURANCE QUERY.



ANAND ROY

I am 24 years old, working at a start-up, and currently covered under my parents' health insurance policy. I am planning to buy my own health cover. What should I focus on?

Sujith

While your healthcare requirements may be limited today, they are likely to evolve with age and changing responsibilities. Consider an adequate sum insured, say ₹10 lakh, that can remain relevant and can provide you good financial protection even if you choose to change jobs or start something on your own.

Some health insurance products offer age-freeze or age-lock features, under which the premium may remain frozen to the age at which the policy was purchased until a claim or any another specified trigger, subject to the policy terms. Also examine how the policy rewards claim-free years. A no-claim bonus can increase your available sum insured over time without requiring a corresponding increase in the base cover.

Assess the insurer's cashless hospital network across India, along with the accessibility of



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

his core skillset at ₹3 lakh, which will enhance his income. He plans to complete it in 2027

* Quarterly travel for the next three years at ₹50,000 per trip

* Buy a bike at an estimated cost of ₹4 lakh this year or next year

* International travel every year from 2028 at an estimated ₹4 lakh in the first year

* Start a family after two years and have the right plan for kids' education.

Yashika is an aggressive risk-taker and understands financial assets.

Sharan wants to have a balanced view on his investments and protect them through diversification. He is keen to close his home loan before investing in financial assets.

OUR REVIEW

* Both were advised to opt for a comprehensive health insurance for a sum assured of ₹25 lakh

* Sharan currently pays ₹32,000 towards his housing loan repayment. If he repays the same amount for the next 12 years, the total interest will be ₹17.45 lakh. He was advised to repay an additional ₹6 lakh for the first two years and ₹8.7 lakh in the third year to close the loan. This will save interest cost of about ₹12 lakh. His current cash flow allows him to follow such a strategy.

* Sharan and Yashika will have ₹4.4 lakh and ₹14 lakh, respectively, as annual surplus.

* Yashika's car purchase to be funded in part with her investments and a car loan for a tenure of three years.

* Sharan and Yashika will contribute equally towards their international vacation at ₹2 lakh per annum. This will help them fund the international vacation from 2028, and will have continuous investments.

* Sharan will invest ₹1.5 lakh per annum — ₹1 lakh in equity mutual funds towards long-term wealth creation and ₹50,000 in fixed income instruments towards medium-term consumption needs. Once he completes his loan repayment, he will increase his investments.

* Sharan will use his current MF portfolio towards his course fees.

* Yashika's portfolio will be

tion will be directed towards her medium-term goals.

* Yashika will invest ₹6 lakh towards long-term wealth creation in a mix of equity and gold portfolio, and ₹2 lakh towards her medium-term goals.

* They may need to alter the bike purchase goal cost or compromise on international vacation for a year. Sharan wants to explore second-hand bike purchase options, thereby making an international vacation possible at a lower cost. This will help them manage their goals without sacrificing on their investments.

Both were keen to keep their

rebalanced to suit her risk appetite with 60 per cent in equity and the rest in in fixed income allocation. Non-equity alloca-



Sakthi Finance
Since 1955

Sakthi Finance Limited

CIN : L65910TZ1955PLC000145

Regd. Office : 62, Dr.Nanjappa Road, Coimbatore – 641 018

Tel : (0422) 4236200 | E-mail : sakthi_info@sakthifinance.com

Website : www.sakthifinance.com

ICRA] BBB (Stable)

Rated by ICRA Ltd

ACCEPTS / RENEWS DEPOSITS

SCHEME I AND II					
Term (months)	Fixed Deposit and Cumulative Deposit Interest rate p.a. (%)	Fixed Deposit (Interest Frequency)		Yield on Maturity (%)	Cumulative Deposit* Amount payable on maturity for ₹ 10,000
		Monthly (%)	Quarterly (%)		
15	8.25	8.25	8.25	8.60	11,075
24	8.50	8.50	8.50	9.16	11,832
36	8.75	8.75	8.75	9.88	12,965
48	9.00	9.00	9.00	10.69	14,276
60	9.00	9.00	9.00	11.21	15,605
Minimum Deposit (₹)		25,000	10,000		10,000

FOR SENIOR CITIZENS SCHEME I AND II					
Term (months)	Fixed Deposit and Cumulative Deposit Interest rate p.a. (%)	Fixed Deposit (Interest Frequency)		Yield on Maturity (%)	Cumulative Deposit* Amount payable on maturity for ₹ 10,000
		Monthly (%)	Quarterly (%)		
15	8.50	8.50	8.50	8.87	11,109
24	8.75	8.75	8.75	9.45	11,890
36	9.00	9.00	9.00	10.20	13,061
48	9.25	9.25	9.25	11.04	14,416
60	9.25	9.25	9.25	11.59	15,797
Minimum Deposit (₹)		25,000	10,000		10,000

- * Interest compounded quarterly.
• For minimum Deposits, refer the above tables.
• Interest rates on existing deposits remain unchanged till maturity.
• Visit our website www.sakthifinance.com for latest Statutory Particulars.
- Minimum Deposit / Additional Deposit :** All deposits (irrespective of the Schemes) received in same name or same order of names (in case of joint deposits) would be controlled in one deposit account. Deposit will be accepted in multiples of ₹ 1,000, subject to a minimum amount of ₹ 10,000 per account.
 - Scheme-I-Fixed Deposit :** Fixed Deposits are accepted for a period at the rates of interest as mentioned overleaf.
 - Monthly interest is payable on the last day of every month.
 - Quarterly interest is payable on the last day of March, June, September and December, every year.
 - All Interest payment/ repayment will be made through electronic mode and issued favouring first depositor only.
 - Scheme-II-Cumulative Deposit :** Cumulative Deposits are accepted for a period at the rates of interest mentioned overleaf. Interest compounded at the respective rates will be credited in our books of accounts to the Depositor's account on the 31 March every year. In all cases, all the accumulated interest is payable only on maturity.
 - Senior Citizen's Deposit Scheme :** To avail the benefit of additional rate of interest, the first depositor should have completed 60 years of age on the date of deposit/renewal. Proof of date of birth must be submitted along with the application form.
 - Monthly interest is payable from 15 to 60 months' deposits.
 - Deposits are accepted / renewed for periods of 15, 24, 36, 48 and 60 months, subject to the terms and conditions as indicated in the application form.
 - Identification of Depositors :** To comply with "Know Your Customer" ("KYC") Guidelines for NBFCs prescribed by the Reserve Bank of India, new depositors should provide a self-attested copy of ID and Address proof. Any one of the following Officially Valid Documents ("OVD") duly self-attested (which contains the photograph of the first named depositor concerned) can be submitted for identification and proof of residential address:
 - (a) Passport (b) Voter's Identity Card (c) Driving Licence (d) Aadhaar Card (Optional) (e) NREGA job card duly signed by the Officer of the State / Central Government (f) Letter issued by the National Population Register containing Name and address.If copy of Aadhaar is provided, kindly provide masked Aadhaar copy only. If the address of the OVD provided differs from the address provided in the application form, the following utility bills which are not more than two (2) months old to be given:
 - (a) Electricity (b) Telephone / Post-paid Mobile (c) Piped gas (d) Water Tax / Municipal or property tax (e) Pension Order issued to the retired Employees by the Government (f) Letter of allotment of house issued by the Government.The above said proofs are also applicable to all the depositors, including the existing depositors and nominee.

- Deposits cannot be accepted / renewed in the absence of the said proof.
- Joint Deposits :** Deposits may be made in the joint names, under Number One or Survivor/s ('N' or 'S') or Anyone or Survivor ('A' or 'S') basis. All correspondence will be addressed to the first depositor. All payment of deposit amounts and interest payments will be effected favouring first depositor only. Photograph needs to be submitted at the time of placing of fresh deposit / renewal of existing deposit. A copy of self-attested PAN Card for all depositors to be provided to the Company.
 - Deposits from Non-Residents** Deposits from Non-Resident Indians are accepted by cheques issued from first depositors Non-Resident Ordinary ("NRO") bank account on non-repatriation basis provided that the amount deposited with the company does not represent inward remittance or transfer from NRE/FNRR(B) accounts into the NRO account. A declaration as above from the depositor, application form for the deposit and other documents have to be produced to the company in person at any of our branches. For non-resident individuals, confirmation letter issued by foreign consulates with updated address can be taken as OVD for address proof.

- Additional documents required for NRI deposits:**
 - (a) Passport with valid Visa (b) Overseas employment letter (Optional for confirmation of residential status and overseas address) (c) A PIO (Person of Indian Origin) card to establish Indian origin, if it is a foreign passport (d) PAN Card (e) a local address proof, if different from the passport address (f) FATCA/CRS Declaration form.Outstation parties may make remittance to nearby Branches or to Registered Office by means of Bank Drafts drawn in favour of the company and crossed "Account Payee". Draft may be obtained for the investment amount less bank charges.

- FATCA-CRS Instructions (Foreign Accounts Tax Compliance Act - Common Reporting Standards)** Depositors (including joint holders/guardian/POA holders) are required to refer and mandatorily fill FATCA-CRS details which form part of the application form. In compliance with the regulations of Government of India, depositors are required to provide their additional information/ certifications/ documents as and when sought by the company. In certain circumstances, the company may be obliged to share information on the depositor's account with relevant authorities. Depositors are required to inform the company promptly whenever there is a change in the status/information already provided to the company.
- Central KYC Registry** Depositors are requested to provide CKYC number, if already allotted, to us to share the information to Central KYC Registry as per RBI Directions.
- Company / Partnership Firm / Hindu Undivided Family / Trusts and Foundations/Unincorporated Association and Body of Individuals** Deposits will be accepted by the company subject to the production of necessary documents as required under the procedure laid down by the Company.

Beneficial Ownership Declaration : As per RBI Directions, for all Non-Individual deposits like Companies, Partnership Firms, Trust, Associations and HUFs, it is mandatory to obtain Beneficial Ownership Declaration form duly filled and signed along with the KYC Proof of the signatories.
- Nomination :** Nomination facility is available for all the individuals. For availing the nomination facility, Depositor(s) is / are required to provide the nominee details in the fresh application / Renewal form. Nomination is mandatory for deposits placed in individual/ sole name.
- Loans on Deposits :** The Company may grant, at its sole discretion, loan against deposit up to 75 per cent of the deposit amount, provided the depositor runs for a minimum period of 3 months. The loan amount shall carry an interest at 2 per cent above the contracted rate. Renewal with loan is not permitted. Payment of maturity amount after adjustment of loan principal and interest thereon will be made on maturity.

individual portfolio choices that suit their risk profiles, while maintaining a combined long-term wealth accumulation goal. Yashika was willing to bring stability to her investments, while Sharan was keen to explore financial investments.

They preferred to stay in a rental apartment to suit their lifestyle and wanted to make a decision on the house a few years later.

The author is the Principal Officer at Plutus Asset Services LLP, a SEBI Registered Investment Advisory firm. <https://plutus.in>

- Renewals :** Cumulative Deposits can be renewed for the maturity value. The Depositors should send the discharged FDR / CDR together with duly completed fresh application to the company at least 10 days before maturity. The Company may, at its discretion, renew the deposit from the date of maturity, only if renewal instruction is received within 6 months from the date of maturity. Otherwise, it will only be renewed prospectively. In case of E or S deposits, a renewal retaining one of the Depositor(s) as the first depositor is possible. Transfer of deposits by a change in the first named depositor is not possible in the case of N or S Deposits.
- Repayments :** On maturity, the Deposit Receipts has to be surrendered to the Company for repayment duly discharged with instructions for repayment. Amount will be paid only by Crossed Account Payee Draft / Cheque / NEFT at our cost.
 - Premature payments :** The Company reserves its right to allow, at its absolute discretion, withdrawal of deposit before maturity. As per the directions of Reserve Bank of India currently in force, rates provided below shall apply:

Up to 3 months from the date of deposit / renewal (lock-in-period)	No repayment (Allowed in the event of death of depositor)
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However, in order to meet certain expenses of emergent nature, subject to the satisfaction of the Company :

Tiny deposit : (Aggregate amount up to ₹ 10,000 for a depositor) may prematurely be paid fully, without interest, to individual Depositor.

Other Deposits : Up to 50 per cent of the Principal Amount or ₹ 5 lakhs, whichever is lower, may be prematurely paid to individual Depositors, without interest. Balance amount will continue as per the terms of the contract.

In case of critical illness*, 100 per cent of the principal amount to be paid prematurely without any interest. For this purpose, expenses of an emergent nature includes medical emergency or expenses due to natural calamities / disaster as notified by the government/authorities concerned.

* Critical illness shall be guided by IRDAI (Health Insurance) Regulations 2016 and the guidelines issued thereunder, as amended from time to time.

Premature payment after 3 months but before 6 months	No interest*
Premature payment after 6 months but before the date of maturity	The interest payable shall be 2 per cent lower than the interest rate applicable to a public deposit for the period for which the deposit had run or if no rate has been specified for that period, then 3 per cent lower than the minimum rate at which deposits are accepted by the Company**.

- * Premature payment can be made without interest in the case of death of the depositor.
** The above rates are also applicable for premature payment in case of death of a depositor.
- In case of non-repayment of the deposit or part thereof as per the terms and conditions of such deposit, the depositor may approach the Southern Regional Bench of the National Company Law Tribunal, Third Floor, Corporate Bhavan, UTI Building, 29, Rajaji Salai, Chennai – 600 001.
 - Interest ceases on the maturity date of deposits, if the deposit is withdrawn after the maturity date.
 - Payment of interest / repayment of Deposit falling due on a Sunday or bank holiday or any day when the Company's Registered Office is not working, due to holiday or otherwise, will be made on the next working day.
 - Any deposit which remains unclaimed for a period of seven years from the date of maturity will be transferred to the "Investor Education and Protection Fund" ("IEPF") established by the Central Government under relevant provisions of the Companies Act 2013.
 - Income Tax :** Tax will be deducted from the interest payable / credited in the Account as per the provisions of Income Tax Act 2025. If a non-assessee depositor requires any exemption from Tax Deduction at Source on interest payment, a valid declaration in Form 121 or any other forms as may be prescribed under the Income Tax Act 2025 needs to be submitted. In case of Cumulative Deposits, interest will be credited on 31st March or Maturity date whichever is earlier and tax deduction, if applicable, will be made. A new Form 121 has to be submitted if an additional deposit is made or when an existing deposit is renewed, even though the depositors may have already furnished the forms for the current financial year.
 - General**
 - The Company reserves its right to reject any application for deposit or for renewal without assigning any reason thereof.
 - Application for Fixed/Cumulative Deposit should be made only using the Application form supplied by the Company.
 - In the event of demise of the first/joint Depositor, ONLY repayment/ premature payment shall be effected favouring the nominee on submission of required documents. If nomination is not available, claimants should furnish the legal heirship certificate.
 - Deposit receipts are not transferable.
 - The Company will not recognize any lien, charge or other encumbrance on the deposit.
 - Depositors are requested to intimate any change of address / bank instructions regarding interest remittance to reach the Company at least 10 days before the next interest payment is due. In case of change in residential address, proof needs to be furnished as per Paragraph 7 above.
 - The financial position of the Company as disclosed and the representations made in the application form are true and correct and that the Company and its Board of Directors are responsible for the correctness and veracity thereof.
 - In case of any deficiency of the Company in servicing its deposit, the depositor may approach the National Consumers Disputes Redressal Forum, the State Consumers Disputes Redressal Forum and District Consumers Disputes Redressal Forum for relief.
 - It is hereby informed that the Public Deposits solicited by the Company are insured.
 - The Company reserves the right to alter or amend without any notice or any all of the terms and conditions stipulated above without assigning any reasons thereof.
 - In case of minor attaining majority, to provide (a) photograph (b) copy of any one of the OVD as KYC proof duly self-attested c) copy of PAN card duly attested.
 - Bank details of the first named depositor is mandatory (to provide copy of cancelled cheque leaf / first page of bank pass book / statement).
 - Interest on Fixed Deposits will be paid through National Electronic Funds Transfer ("NEFT") and depositors must provide details of Name of the Account holder, Name of Bank and Branch, Bank Account Number and IFSC Code.
 - Deposit can be renewed on maturity date subject to the terms and conditions for acceptance of deposit in force at that time.

Particulars required to be specified as per the provisions of Reserve Bank of India (Non-Banking Financial Companies - Acceptance of Public Deposits) Directions 2025 and Non-Banking Financial Companies & Miscellaneous Non-Banking Companies (Advertisement) Rules 1977, as amended, are given below:

A	Name of the company	Sakthi Finance Limited
B	Date of incorporation of the Company	March 30, 1955
C	Business carried on by the Company and its subsidiaries with details of branches or units, if any	Financing of pre-owned Commercial Vehicles, Machinery, Industrial Equipments etc and other finance related activities
Details of Branches TAMIL NADU: Ariyalur, Chennai (Mylapore), Chennai (Tambaram), Coimbatore (North), Coimbatore (South), Dharmapuri, Dindigul, Erode, Hosur, Kallakurichi, Kanchipuram, Karaikudi, Kumbakonam, Madurai, Madhavaram, Mettupalayam, Nagarcoil, Namakkal, Perambalur, Pollachi, Sakthi Nagar, Salem, Sankaragi, Sivakasi, Srirangam, Theni, Tirunelveli, Tirupur, Trichy, Tuticorin and Vellore KERALA: Alapuzha, Ernakulam, Kanhangad, Kannur, Kattappana, Kottayam, Kozhikode, Manjeri, Muvattupuzha, Pala, Palakkad, Pathanamthitta, Thrissur and Vadakara KARNATAKA: Bengaluru - Infantry Road Cross, Bengaluru - JP Nagar and Mangaluru MAHARASHTRA: Mumbai (Nariman Point) ANDHRA PRADESH: Rajahmundry, Vijayawada and Visakhapatnam NEW DELHI PUDUCHERRY		
D	Brief particulars of Management of the Company	The Company is managed by the Vice Chairman and Managing Director under the control and supervision of the Board of Directors
E	Names, Addresses and Occupations of the Directors	
	Name	Address Occupations
	Dr. M Manickam (Chairman) DIN : 00102233	No.25, Rukmani Nagar Ramanathapuram Coimbatore – 641 045 Industrialist
	Sri M Balasubramaniam (Vice Chairman and Managing Director) DIN: 00377053	No.27 & 28, Rukmani Nagar Ramanathapuram Coimbatore – 641 045 Industrialist

Your Money • bl • 3

ALERTS.

ICICI Pru Mutual Fund to launch Contra Fund offering

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund will open the new fund offer (NFO) of ICICI Prudential Contra Fund on September 28. The offer will close on October 12. The scheme is an open-ended equity fund following a contrarian investment strategy. The fund will seek opportunities in companies and market segments that are out of favour or appear mispriced for recovery. The investment approach will consider factors such as valuations, business cycles, potential triggers and investor sentiment. The fund house also plans to assess leverage, ownership patterns, upside potential and disruption risks while selecting stocks.

The strategy will look at factors such as stock-price patterns, management transitions, near-term sentiment weakness, regulatory developments and the competitive landscape. It will also monitor institutional ownership and leverage. The scheme will follow a research-driven, non-consensus approach. It is positioned for investors seeking mispriced opportunities and having a long-term horizon, with the willingness to wait for a reversal in market sentiment. The scheme will be managed by Sankaran Naren, Dharmesh Kakkad, Sakshat Goel and Gaurav Chikane, and will be benchmarked against the Nifty 500 TRI. The minimum application amount during the NFO is ₹1,000, with amounts above this accepted in multiples of ₹1. SIP, SWP and STP facilities will be available.



Sri M Srinivasan (Director) DIN: 00102387	"Swagatham" 2nd Cross, 3rd Main Defence Colony, Indiranagar Bengaluru - 560 038	Industrialist
Dr S Veluswamy (Director) DIN:005314999	Door No.19/20, Second Street Karapavaiyagar Nagar Maniyakarampalayam Road Ganapathy, Coimbatore - 641 006	Service
Sri Advait Kurlkar (Independent Director) DIN: 00808669	"Adhunaiv" 55, Prashant Society Paid Road, Kothrud Ex Servicemen Colony Pune - 411 038	HR Consultant
Sri K V Ramachandran (Independent Director) DIN: 00322331	A-3, Sirram Apartments 80, St. Mary's Road Abhiramapuram, Teynampet Chennai - 600 018	Industrialist
Smt Susheela Balakrishnan (Independent Director) DIN: 07140637	No. 76, Sri Lakshmi Nagar 2 Thanneerpanthal Road Peelamedu Coimbatore – 641 004	Practicing Chartered Accountant
Sri S Shivram (Independent Director) DIN: 07946245	167A, F3 Jain Eiffel Garden Arcot Salai, Vadapalani Chennai – 600 026	HR Consultant
Sri S Chandrasekar (Director) DIN: 00011901	No. 226, Tea Estate Compound Race Course Coimbatore – 641 018	Industrialist
Sri Saurabh Jain (Independent Director) DIN: 02322422	E1707, Oberoi Splendor, JVLR Opp. Majas Depot, Jogeshwari East Mumbai - 400 060	Professional

(F) & (G) Profits of the Company before and after making provision for tax and dividends declared by the Company for the three financial years immediately preceding the date of advertisement.

Year ended	Profit before taxation (₹ Lakhs)	Profit after taxation (₹ Lakhs)	Total Comprehensive Income (₹ Lakhs)	Rate of dividend declared on Equity Shares	Preference Shares
31.03.2026	2,340.06	1,724.90	1,700.41	8%*	9.00% (Interim, pro rata)
31.03.2025	2,333.13	1,665.15	1,629.99	8%	8.25% and 9.00% (Interim, pro rata)
31.03.2024	2,147.79	1,570.54	1,602.62	8%	8.25% and 9.00% (Interim) & (Pro rata)

* subject to the approval of members at the ensuing 69th Annual General Meeting.
H) Summarized Financial Position of the Company as appearing in two latest audited Balance Sheets immediately preceding the date of advertisement:

Particulars	(₹ Lakhs)	
	As at 31.3.2026 (Audited)	As at 31.3.2025 (Audited)
ASSETS		
Financial Assets		
Cash and Cash equivalents	15,535.20	4,415.39
Bank Balances other than cash and cash equivalents	2,710.94	688.86
Receivables:		
(a) Trade Receivables	34.54	96.49
(b) Other Receivables	8.76	22.89
Loans	1,07,310.41	1,18,079.70
Investments	6,023.38	2,306.35
Other Financial Assets	1,492.09	1,770.47
Non-Financial Assets		
Current Tax Asset (net)	95.24	-
Deferred Tax Assets (net)	277.15	479.35
Investment Property	262.40	268.25
Property, Plant and Equipment	5,495.59	5,507.52
Right of use assets	1,121.53	907.28
Capital work-in-progress	-	13.69
Intangible Assets under development	-	246.86
Other Intangible Assets	1,144.49	138.31
Other Non-Financial Assets	1,840.57	1,819.84
Total Assets	1,43,352.29	1,36,761.25
LIABILITIES AND EQUITY		
LIABILITIES		
Financial Liabilities		
Payables:		
(i) Trade Payables:		
(i) total outstanding dues of micro enterprises and small enterprises	9.66	11.22
(ii) total outstanding dues of creditors other than micro enterprises and small enterprises	123.54	117.64
(II) Other Payables:		
(i) total outstanding dues of micro enterprises and small enterprises	-	-
(ii) total outstanding dues of creditors other than micro enterprises and small enterprises	131.09	431.48
Debt Securities	78,211.30	67,368.98
Borrowings (Other than Debt Securities)	8,090.60	12,384.82
Deposits	21,905.47	18,712.18
Subordinated Liabilities	8,661.32	12,388.53
Other Financial Liabilities	1,686.96	1,882.47
Non-Financial Liabilities		
Current Tax Liabilities (net)	-	103.72
Provisions	140.46	153.56
Other Non-Financial Liabilities	259.82	257.34
EQUITY		
Equity Share Capital	6,470.59	6,470.59
Other Equity	17,661.48	16,478.72
Total Liabilities and Equity	1,43,352.29	1,36,761.25

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

With Indian equities turning more selective and benchmark returns losing momentum, stock selection is back in focus. Investors looking for an actively managed large-cap fund with a strong record across market phases can consider Invesco India Large Cap Fund. The scheme carries a 5-star rating in the *bl-portfolio* Star Track Ratings. The case rests less on one standout return number and more on consistency, portfolio evolution and efficient use of risk.

This is not a defensive large-cap strategy. The over 17-year-old fund stays almost fully invested, takes meaningful sector and stock positions, and uses most of the flexibility available outside large-caps. Yet, its rolling returns and risk-adjusted ratios remain among the strongest in the category. This combination makes it interesting when many large-cap funds struggle to create meaningful separation from the benchmark.

Passive investing has a strong case in large caps. Active managers often struggle to beat indices consistently after costs.

STRATEGY

Invesco India Large Cap has changed substantially over the past decade. In September 2016, it held 31 stocks and the top 10 accounted for about 66 per cent of the portfolio. By August 2017, the stock count had fallen to 20 and the top 10 made up more than 72 per cent. Even in August 2021, 31 stocks made up the portfolio, with the top 10 at 63.2 per cent. That fund structure has since broadened. By August 2026, the fund held 55 stocks and the top 10 accounted for 39.8 per cent. Sector concentration has moved the same way. The top five sectors made up 69.5 per cent of assets in August 2021. They now account for just under 50 per cent.

This shift coincided with a rise in assets. AUM grew from about ₹398 crore in August 2021 to ₹2,021 crore by August 2026. The fund is still modest-sized compared with several category peers, so there is little evidence that scale itself forced diversification. Market appreciation and investor flows also contributed to AUM growth. But the timing is notable. As the fund grew, it steadily spread risk across more stocks and sectors.

What has not changed is its willingness to stay invested. Over the 10-year asset-allocation history, domestic equities averaged 97.8 per cent of assets. Cash averaged only 2.1 per cent. Current equity exposure is 99.4 per cent. Its strong multi-year outcomes, therefore, have not come from sitting on cash during difficult phases.

PORTFOLIO

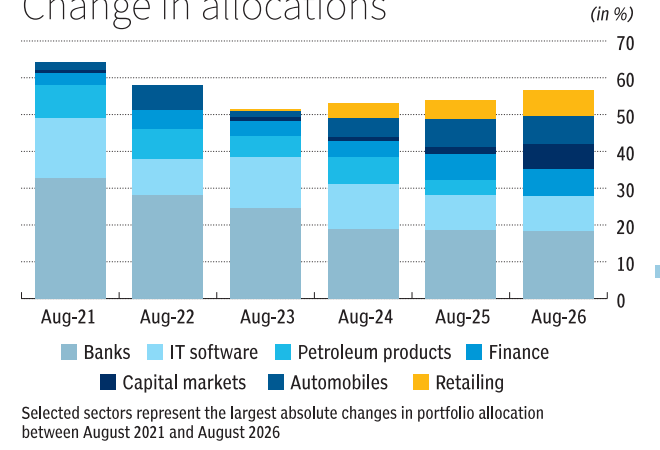
The current portfolio of Invesco India Large Cap is broader than the fund’s own past, but not unusually broad versus peers. Its 55 stocks are only slightly above the large-cap category median of 52. The real active element lies in what the fund owns and what it avoids. Large-caps currently form 80.06 per cent of the portfolio, close to the regulatory minimum. Mid-caps account for

FUND CALL. Invesco India Large Cap

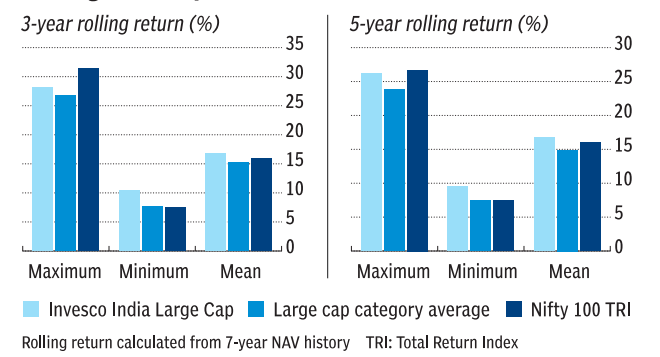
A changing playbook delivers better outcomes

The fund combines strong consistency, active choices and efficient risk-taking across market cycles

Change in allocations



Rolling returns performance



How it stands apart

Selected parameter	Fund	Large-cap category average
Large-cap allocation (%)	80.1	84.0
Mid-cap allocation (%)	10.1	11.2
Small-cap allocation (%)	8.4	2.0
Other allocation (%)	1.5	2.8
Top-5 stock allocation (%)	23.5	29.8
Top-10 stock allocation (%)	39.8	46.6
Upside capture* (%)	117.7	100.6
Downside capture* (%)	102.6	96.5
Portfolio P/E (times)	42.4	35.5
Portfolio P/B (times)	9.5	7.2

*Calculated for 3 years monthly basis Data above for latest disclosed portfolios Source: ACEMF

10.11 per cent and small-caps 8.39 per cent. The category holds only about 2 per cent in small-caps. This gives Invesco a meaningfully different risk profile from a conventional large-cap fund.

Banks remain the largest sector at 18.36 per cent, well below the category’s 26.16 per cent. But the fund is not light on financials. Finance and capital market businesses form another 14.29 per cent. Together, the three financial segments make up 32.65 per cent, slightly above the category.

The difference is in composi-

tion. Invesco has less traditional banking and more non-bank finance and capital market exposure. Capital Markets alone is 6.73 per cent against 0.90 per cent for the category. It is also overweight IT Software, Transport Services, Electrical Equipment, Retailing and Automobiles.

The stock history shows both patience and willingness to change. HDFC Bank appears in all 120 monthly observations in the 10-year data. Infosys appears in 114. ICICI Bank has been held continuously since September 2019 and is now the largest stock



at 8.46 per cent. But former anchors have also been sold. Reliance Industries was held for 103 months and once reached 14.21 per cent of the portfolio. It exited by September 2025. Kotak Mahindra Bank, Maruti Suzuki, TCS and ITC have also disappeared. The fund has also shown willingness to move away from long-held positions. Recent positions further differentiate the portfolio from peers. Eternal has grown to 3.74 per cent since entering in 2023. Coforge is at 2.67 per cent after entering in 2024. ICICI Prudential AMC, a much newer holding, is already at 3.70 per cent. There is a price for this positioning. At 42.39 times earnings and 9.49 times book value, the portfolio is the third-most expensive among the analysed 30+ actively-managed large-cap funds on both measures. Valuation is a key current risk. The portfolio needs its growth and stock-selection calls to keep delivering.

PERFORMANCE

The return record is the strongest part of the case for Invesco India Largecap Fund. In SIP data as of September 22, 2026, the fund ranks third over one year and second over three, five, seven and 10 years among funds with data. SIP XIRR stands at 4.7 per cent, 6.4 per cent, 10.9 per cent, 13.3 per cent and 12.9 per cent respectively.

Rolling returns show this is not simply a favourable end-date effect. Over three-year rolling periods calculated from the previous seven years, the minimum return was 10.4 per cent, second-

best in the category. Median and mean returns were 16.9 per cent and 16.7 per cent, both fourth-best.

The five-year picture is similar. The minimum was 9.5 per cent, while the median and mean were 17.37 per cent and 16.80 per cent. All three ranked fourth. Its maximum rolling returns were not category-leading. That is why the record is interesting. Strength has come from consistently good holding-period outcomes, not a few exceptional windfalls.

The fund’s risk ratios add an interesting twist. Invesco had the second-highest Sharpe, Sortino and Treynor ratios among 30+ comparable funds, while its information ratio ranked third and Jensen alpha fourth. In simple terms, the fund has been rewarded well for the risks it has taken, both at the portfolio and benchmark-relative levels. But this has not come from playing safe. Invesco had the second-highest beta and third-highest volatility, showing investors had to tolerate greater swings for excess returns.

Upside capture of 117.7 was second-highest, while downside capture was 102.6. It has not been especially defensive in falling markets. Instead, the extra upside captured has more than compensated for the slightly greater downside.

Strong minimum rolling returns should not be confused with low volatility. Invesco has delivered strong long-term outcomes from poor entry points, but it can still fall harder than benchmark in shorter negative phases. There have been weak patches. FY22-23 saw the fund underperform category and rank 26th out of 33 peers. The fund’s current top-tier standing has coincided with a significantly changed portfolio, rather than representing an uninterrupted history of leadership.

In conclusion, Invesco India Large Cap fits investors seeking an active core large-cap allocation with a horizon of at least five-seven years. They should be comfortable with above-average volatility, meaningful active calls and a higher-than-category small-cap allocation. It is less suitable for investors wanting a benchmark-like or low-volatility large-cap product.

For those willing to accept active risk, its combination of rolling consistency, differentiated positioning and strong risk-adjusted outcomes makes a persuasive case.

US 30-year Treasury yield drifts higher

GLOBAL VIEW. Tops 5.5% on the last day of a bruising week after a consumer sentiment gauge exceeded estimates

Bloomberg

The yield on US government 30-year debt reached fresh multi-year highs on the last day of a bruising week after a gauge of consumer sentiment exceeded economist estimates.

The 30-year Treasury yield, which reached the highest level since 2004 on Thursday, rose as much as five basis points to 5.53 per cent. It was below 5 per cent as recently as early July. The 10-year note’s yield also reached a fresh multi-year high exceeding 5.22 per cent.

“There’s no real technical levels for people to hang on to, and it leaves things in a bit of a vacuum,” said Izaac Brook, US rates strategist at RBC Capital Markets. “That allows yields to just keep drifting higher and higher.”

Longer-term Treasury yields climbed on Friday even as those on shorter-term debt — which are more sensitive to shifting expectations for Federal Reserve interest-rate hikes aimed at throttling inflation — declined.

The 30-year yield was just

over 5.50 per cent on Friday afternoon in New York, about three basis points higher on the day, while the two-year was about seven basis points lower. “There’s too much priced in the front end,” said Monty Gandhi, rates strategist at SMBC Group.

“Short-term investors are looking to buy the front end thinking that any more bearishness should flow into the belly or a higher-for-longer expression.”

Short-term yields reached multi-year highs earlier this week in anticipation that the September Fed rate increase, the first since 2023, would be the first of several as the US war in West Asia undergirds energy prices.

OIL PRICES

Friday’s increase in long-term yields also was at odds with a drop in oil prices, which have been a dominant driver of daily changes in Treasury yields during the war-related supply shock. US benchmark West Texas Intermediate crude futures settled down 2.3 per cent at \$92.41.

“With rate hikes now being delivered in direct response to



higher energy prices, there is no clear near-term upper bound on hikes that can be priced in by the market,” Citigroup economist Andrew Holtenhorst said in a report.

Interest-rate strategists at Morgan Stanley increased their Treasury yield forecasts based on the firm’s recently revised forecast for additional Fed tightening, noting that market

● **DROP IN OIL RATE**
US benchmark West Texas Intermediate crude futures settled down 2.3 per cent at \$92.41

pricing of the Fed’s path explains most of the movement in 10-year yields.

Rising Treasury yields re-

flect not just the potential for higher energy prices to keep broader inflation gauges elevated but also indications that the US economy and companies are coping well with higher interest rates. The consumer sentiment gauge released Friday by the University of Michigan, despite falling to a four-month low in September held up better than economists anticipated.

YIELD CURVE

Friday’s yield moves widened the gaps between short- and long-term yields, with key segments such as the two- to 10-year and five- to 30-year rebounding from the lowest levels in more than a year, reached earlier this week as short-term yield initially rose more.

Activity in Treasury futures was consistent with traders taking profits on those wagers. For example, a pair of block trades involving the five-year note and Ultra Bond futures contracts executed simultaneously shortly before 10 a.m. New York time were done at price levels suggesting the five-year was bought and the Ultra Bond was sold.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
as on Sep 25				
ETF				
Motilal Oswal BSE Quality	192.8	207.6	6.7	7
UTI BSE India Sector Leaders	14.2	14.9	4.7	67
Motilal Oswal Nifty Realty	87.3	87.1	2.1	1,948
Axis Nifty Energy ETF	18.8	19.3	1.8	89
Growth Nifty Realty ETF	9.8	9.7	1.8	2,911
Kotak Nifty 200 Quality 30	19.8	20.2	1.4	39
Growth Nifty Metal ETF	12.5	12.5	1.3	1,611
GOLD ETFs				
Union Gold ETF	147.4	147.6	-1.4	410
LIC Mf Gold ETF	135.7	135.7	-1.4	492
Quantum Gold ETF	124.8	124.8	-1.5	597

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on September 25, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Sep 25	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	52.2	9.1	8.0	12.1	84,399
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.0	10.0	9.0	12.0	32,619
Kotak Pension Fund	65.5	9.3	8.8	11.8	4,874
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.3	6.4	5.8	7.6	9,328
SBI Pension Fund	41.9	6.5	5.8	7.0	31,577
HDFC Pension Fund	28.7	6.1	5.5	6.9	57,211
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.7	7.5	6.6	7.7	36,660
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.4	7.5	6.4	7.6	14,933
SBI Pension Fund	46.5	7.5	6.4	7.5	16,782
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	45.4	9.3	8.2	12.1	1,920
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	56.7	9.7	9.0	12.0	865
Kotak Pension Fund	57.7	9.3	8.9	11.8	233

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on September 25, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	379	21.3	19.1	23.7
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	4	8.7	16.6	15.4
ICICI Pru	Largecap	945	11.1	18.8	15.0
Nippon Life India	Absolute Freedom	NA	10.7	15.8	13.6
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	22.8	18.8	42.0
Samvit Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	NA	26.0	19.3	23.7
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	9,547	18.2	32.7	23.6
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	119	14.2	22.2	23.5
Systematix Shares And Stock (I)	Dynamic Investment	NA	33.7	25.7	21.8
Turtle Wealth Management	Profit Mantra	NA	28.3	18.5	21.3
MID-CAP					
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	26.1	15.0	18.0
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	47.5	24.0	15.9
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	15.4	15.8	15.3
Renaissance Invest. Managers	Midcap Portfolio	NA	0.9	8.3	15.1
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,380	34.7	27.4	32.5
Counter Cyclical Invest.	Diversified Long Term Value	1,087	14.7	18.6	29.2
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,633	1.1	18.2	22.7
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	267	25.1	18.6	22.3

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on August 31, 2026

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I will soon complete 10 years of being listed, but have more than 30 years of business history, while my founders have a much longer legacy.
- My chairman from my initial days retired recently and handed over to his son. He is one of the few Indians who can claim credentials from MIT, Stanford and Harvard, after a brief stint at IIT Bombay.
- While my revenues crossed a billion dollars in recent years, I’ve had a market capitalisation of more than a billion dollars since listing.
- Despite double-digit revenue and profit growth over the last 10 years, with return on equity consistently above 15 per cent, I haven’t provided any returns to shareholders.
- A majority of my seven-member board of directors are women, including all my independent directors.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction
Last week’s stock: SML Mahindra
Last week’s winner: Shiva Shanker

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,141) and Nifty Bank (55,580) fell 0.9 per cent and 1.4 per cent, respectively. While the former posted a seventh consecutive weekly decline, the latter is down for five weeks straight. While the momentum is strongly in favour of the bears, which is supported by the futures and options data, a relief rally is likely to occur after a long downswing. Supporting this, the chart shows that both indices are now hovering near a notable support.

NIFTY 50
Nifty (Oct) futures (23,264) slipped 0.9 per cent along with an increase in outstanding Open Interest (OI) by 164 per cent to 104.2 lakh contracts during the past week. While this indicates a considerable short build-up, part of the increase in OI can be attributed to rollover of positions as September contracts expire on Tuesday (September 29). The cumulative OI (combining September, October and November futures) stood at 249 lakh contracts on Friday, the highest since March 30 when it was 307 lakh contracts. Note that the trend turned bullish after March 30. The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of October contract remained at 1.1 on Friday. A ratio above 1 in the October series shows a positive bias as traders have sold relatively a greater number of put options compared to call options. Participants sell puts when they are bullish. Together, the derivatives data do not give a definite signal. That said, the chart set-up is what gives the bulls some hope. Although the downward momentum is strong, the chart of



the underlying Nifty 50 index shows that there is a support at 23,000. The equivalent level in October futures is 23,100. If there is a recovery on the back of this, Nifty (Oct) futures can see an uptick to 23,650. A breach of this can take it to 23,725. However, if the support at 23,100 is breached, the contract can fall to 22,700. **Strategy:** Buy Nifty (Oct) futures now at 23,264. Place stop-loss at 23,000. Book profits at 23,650.

F&O TRENDS

- Seven-week slide weighs on Nifty
- Nifty Bank falls for fifth week
- Rollover lifts OI in index futures

Option traders can buy Oct expiry 23,500-call option (₹190.10). Go long now at ₹190. Target and stop-loss can be ₹370

and ₹100 respectively. Risk-averse traders can avoid this since this is a counter-trend position and also the risk-reward ratio is not very attractive.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank (Oct) futures (55,963) lost 1.5 per cent last week. But OI shot up 325 per cent to 14.2 lakh contracts, with a part of the increase due to the rollover of trades. The cumulative OI stood at 31.4 lakh contracts on Friday, the highest since June 29 and March 30 where it was 31.7 lakh contracts and 36.4 lakh contracts, respectively. The index rallied after March 30. The PCR of October options stood at 0.9 on Friday. But it had increased from 0.6 a week back. This shows that during last week, traders sold more puts compared with calls. The derivatives data, like in Nifty 50, do not show a clear inclination in Nifty Bank too. The chart of Nifty Bank shows that the support at 55,300 is a considerable base. While a bullish trend reversal might not occur, there could be a temporary rally in the index and the futures. The support for Nifty Bank (Oct) futures is at 55,700. A rebound against this can lift it to 57,000. Instead, if the contract breaches the support at 55,700, the downtrend is likely to be extended to 55,000 and subsequently to 54,750. **Strategy:** Traders can buy Nifty Bank (Oct) futures now at 55,963. Keep initial stop-loss at 55,500. Book profits at 56,900. Option traders can buy Oct expiry 56,500-call option (₹602.10). Go long at ₹600. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,100 and ₹350, respectively. Risk-averse traders can refrain from this strategy.

Setting up ratio bull call spread

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Additional long call facilitates greater profit potential at the short strike

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

A bull call spread involves going long on a lower strike call and short on a higher strike call of the same expiry on the same underlying. What if you instead go long on two contracts of the lower strike call and short one contract of the higher strike call? This week, we discuss the ratio bull call spread and explore the conditions under which initiating the strategy may be optimal.



VOLATILITY PLAY
Your outlook on the underlying must be bullish. But why a ratio bull call spread instead of a bull call spread? Suppose the implied volatility of calls is lower compared to the recent past, it means calls are trading cheap. This can improve your potential reward if you go long on two contracts of the lower strike call. Why? A long position is exposed to time decay — loss in time value with each passing day. Now, time value, and therefore time decay, is a function of the demand for a strike at a given point in time. The higher the demand, the greater the time

● PLAY IT SMART

Low volatility must be at play for you to lean towards the ratio bull call spread

value. And the greater the time value, the larger the time decay. Conversely, buying calls when implied volatility is lower leads to lower losses from time decay. Now, implied volatility is likely to be lower for calls when its underlying has seen a secular downturn. In the context of options trading, we define a secular

downtrend as five to seven consecutive decline days. During this period, puts are likely to be in high demand; compared to the recent past, implied volatility of puts will most likely be higher than that of calls. You can look for appropriate candlestick reversal patterns along with other technical factors to ascertain if the underlying price shows signs of bear exhaustion and signs of bullish reversal. That is when it is optimal to set up the ratio bull call spread. So, low volatility must be at play for you to lean towards the ratio bull call spread. Your trade-off in setting up the

position lies in the choice of expiry. The longer the expiry (near-month), the lower the speed of time decay but higher the time value, and greater the total net debit. If you were to set up the spread with, say, next-week expiry, time decay will accelerate but the total net debit will be lower. So, the higher the price target and the sooner the expected jump in volatility, the more beneficial it is to trade next-week options. **OPTIONAL READING**
The maximum profit potential in a bull call spread is capped at the short higher strike. In the case of a ratio bull call spread, the profit potential is greater at the short strike because of the additional long call. Also, the additional long call provides further gains when the underlying moves past the higher strike. But the position's risk is higher because of the higher net debit. Note that the NSE SPAN spread margin benefits are the same as in the case of bull call spread. The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Above a key base

BULLION CUES. Traders can hold the longs

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,285/ounce) and silver (\$64.30/ounce) were down 2.1 and 2.9 per cent, respectively. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,50,881/10 gm) fell 2.3 per cent whereas silver futures (₹2,34,696/kg) was down 2.9 per cent. **MCX-Gold (₹1,50,881)**
Gold (Oct) futures declined through last week. However, it managed to remain above the key support at ₹1,50,000. Since the start of this month, the contract has largely been trading within ₹1,50,000 and ₹1,55,000. Nevertheless, the support at ₹1,50,000 is a crucial one and so long as this level holds, the probability for a rally will be high. A potential upswing from the current level can lift gold futures to ₹1,67,000. However, if the support at ₹1,50,000 is breached, the contract can decline to ₹1,44,000. **Trade strategy:** Retain the longs that we suggested on gold (Oct) futures at ₹1,52,700 with a stop-loss at ₹1,49,000. When the contract goes up to ₹1,60,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,55,000. Book profits at ₹1,67,000.



MCX-Silver (₹2,34,696)
Silver (Dec) futures witnessed a fall in price last week but ended above ₹2,30,000. The contract has been oscillating between ₹2,30,000 and ₹2,45,000 since the beginning of this month. While the direction of the breach of the above-mentioned range is likely to decide the path of the next swing in price, the support at ₹2,30,000 is an important one. Until this level holds, bulls will have an edge. The contract can surpass ₹2,45,000 and extend the upswing to ₹2,60,000. But if ₹2,30,000 is invalidated, it can witness a deeper fall, probably to ₹2,18,500. **Trade strategy:** Hold the long on silver (Dec) futures initiated at ₹2,37,500. Maintain the stop-loss at ₹2,29,000. When the contract rises to ₹2,50,000, raise the stop-loss to ₹2,42,000. Book profits at ₹2,60,000.

Bulls hold the edge

CRUDE CHECK. Support can trigger a rebound

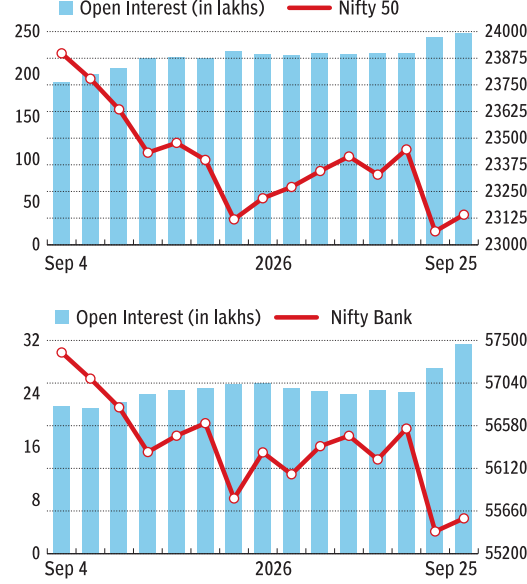
Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Oil prices remained volatile last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$104.30/barrel) was up 0.4 per cent whereas crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,848/barrel) fell 4.1 per cent. **BRENT FUTURES (\$104.30)**
Brent crude (Nov) futures kept the traders busy last week as it dropped in the first half and saw a sharp recovery, particularly on Wednesday and Thursday. A rebound from the 21-day moving average shows that the bulls are in control and price drops are being bought. As it stands, the Brent crude futures retain a positive bias and the probability for a rally is high. It has the potential to surpass the resistance at \$110 and \$115. Resistance above \$115 is at \$130. However, if the support at \$92 is taken out, the near-term outlook can turn bearish. In this case, the contract can fall to \$84. **MCX Crude Oil (₹8,848)**
Crude oil (Oct) futures experienced a volatile week. Early last

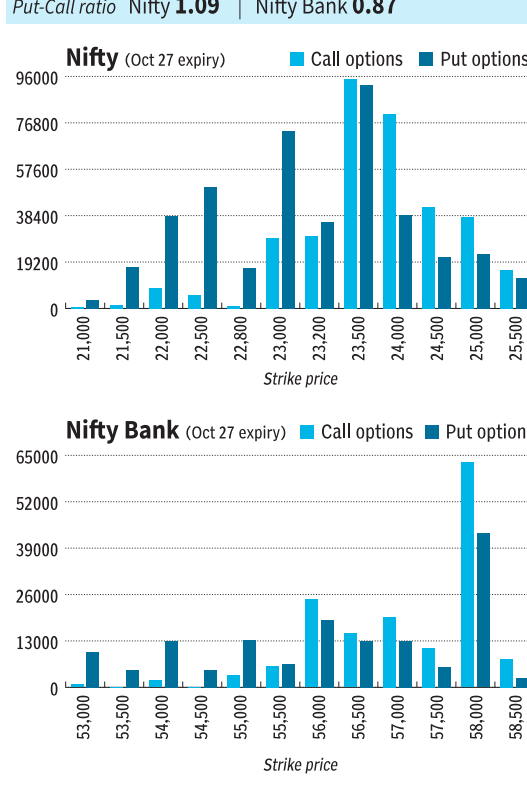


week, the price declined following an attempt for a recovery. However, the recovery lacked strength and the contract ended the week with a loss. That said, the contract has a support at ₹8,500, where a trendline coincides. Below this is another support at ₹8,160, its 50-day moving average. So long as these levels hold, the bullish bias will remain. A rally, either from the current level of ₹8,848 or after a fall to ₹8,160-8,500 price band, can take the contract to ₹10,500. Resistance above ₹10,500 is at ₹11,000. Instead, if the support at ₹8,160 fails to hold, the crude oil futures can decline to ₹7,500 and subsequently to ₹7,000. **Trade strategy:** Retain the buy suggested at ₹9,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹10,500 and ₹8,300, respectively.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain (as on Sep 25)



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Sep 25	Weekly change %	As on Sep 25	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	46,305	-4	310,325	4
Future Index Short	358,306	6	65,926	17
Net Futures	-312,001	8	244,399	1
Index Call options Long	857,125	24	3,903,133	8
Index Call options Short	1,098,094	14	3,729,638	11
Net Call options	-240,969	-10	173,495	-26
Index Put options Long	1,401,782	8	2,935,201	-5
Index Put options Short	717,999	7	3,877,611	0
Net Put Options	683,783	8	-942,410	18

FII's have increased net short on index futures and have also added net long on index put options. Shows bearish bias.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Sep 25)				
POLICYBZR	1,166.00	-33.1	698.9	380.7
OFSS	10,770.00	-9.5	46.6	44.7
MFSL	1,458.00	-6.5	138.2	39.6
LTF	284.00	-9.2	1316.6	38.9
PATANJALI	403.95	10.1	703.1	36.2
FALL (as on Sep 25)				
KEI	4,673.50	0.5	67.6	-26.2
POLYCAB	8,408.50	0.1	62.7	-17.7
SOLARINDS	19,745.00	6.4	40.0	-17.6
IREDA	113.22	-1.0	1673.4	-16.3
NESTLEIND	1,362.60	-0.7	169.4	-16.0

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Sep 28)

KAYNES	LICHSGFIN	MANAPPURAM	SAIL
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Change in OI and market positioning

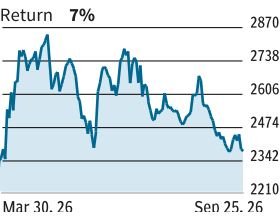
Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Sep 25)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Oct	348.7 (-0.9)	3,603 (144)	Short build-up
COPPER	30-Oct	1,419.3 (0.6)	8,806 (130)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	19-Oct	8,848.0 (-4.1)	13,029 (-7)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOILM	19-Oct	8,847.0 (-4.1)	39,278 (9)	Short build-up
GOLD	5-Oct	1,50,881.0 (-2.3)	4,870 (-40)	Long unwinding
GOLDGUINEA	30-Oct	1,22,383.0 (-2.1)	13,175 (101)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Oct	1,50,893.0 (-2.3)	29,109 (-8)	Long unwinding
GOLDPETAL	30-Oct	15,302.0 (-2.0)	1,82,926 (57)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Oct	1,52,600.0 (-2.0)	25,189 (68)	Short build-up
LEAD	30-Oct	194.9 (-1.0)	543 (87)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	27-Oct	310.6 (6.1)	26,086 (71)	Long build-up
SILVER	4-Dec	2,34,696.0 (-2.9)	14,756 (26)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Nov	2,36,663.0 (-2.7)	36,650 (14)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Nov	2,36,727.0 (-2.6)	1,16,011 (18)	Short build-up
ZINC	30-Oct	422.4 (1.3)	2,498 (118)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Sep 25)				
USDINR	28-Oct	96.12 (-0.1)	5,25,075 (429)	Short build-up
EURINR	28-Oct	109.82 (-1.1)	2,042 (-)	-
GBPINR	28-Oct	127.58 (-)	1812(-)	-
JPYINR	28-Oct	60.10 (-)	6(-)	-

F&O Strategy

Long strangle on HDFC AMC

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for the stock of HDFC Asset Management Company or HDFC AMC (₹2,378) remains neutral. It has been moving in the ₹2,200-2,900 band in the last six months. Only a break away from the current band will set a clear trend for HDFC AMC. Immediate support is at ₹2,313 whereas the nearest resistance is at ₹2,500. If HDFC AMC dips below ₹2,210, it can drop to ₹1,820. However, a close above ₹2,455 will lift the stock towards ₹2,760. We expect the stock to soon break out of the above-mentioned band.



F&O pointers: HDFC AMC September futures closed at ₹2,379.30 and October futures at ₹2,391.50 against the spot close of ₹2,378. The counter witnessed a rollover of nearly 67 per cent to October series, and the premium indicates rollover of long positions. **Strategy:** Consider long strangle on HDFC AMC using October contracts. This can be done by buying 2600-call and 2100-put. As these options closed at ₹13.70 and ₹6 respectively, this will cost traders ₹5,910. This will be the maximum loss and that will occur if the stock is stuck between ₹2,600 and ₹2,100. A move above ₹2,619.70 or below ₹2,080.30 will start turning the position profitable. Hold the position for two weeks and aim for a target of ₹8,000 (based on combined position). Exit the position if the loss mounts to ₹1,000.

Follow-up: Recommendation on InterGlobe Aviation hit the target. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

Trading volume Vs OI

BL Research Bureau

When it comes to trading liquidity, a critical prerequisite is that the derivative contracts of stocks/commodities that are more liquid are preferred for trading over those that are less liquid so that entries and exits can be executed with ease. Trading volume and Open Interest (OI) are the metrics that can tell us about the liquidity of the derivative contracts. Not only liquidity, but also good gauges of the market sentiment can help us understand the direction and the strength of a trend. But often there is confusion over the difference between volume and OI and how they are measured. Here, we look at the difference between these two metrics.



Volume measures the number of contracts being exchanged between buyers and sellers in a particular trading session i.e., every transaction is added. On the other hand, OI is the number of contracts that are outstanding at that time and they are added and subtracted based on whether the contract is created new or liquidation of contracts that are already open. For example, Trader A buys 10 option contracts of a stock from Trader B. Post this transaction, both volume and OI will be 10. But if Trader A sells back 5 contracts to Trader B, the volume will go up to 15 whereas the OI will drop to 5. So, the key difference is that OI will go up only if new contracts are created whereas trading volume will go up irrespective of opening or a closing transaction.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index extended their fall last week inline with our expectation. Sensex and Nifty were down 0.54 per cent and 0.88 per cent respectively. Nifty Bank index on the other hand fell 1.38 per cent. On the charts, the picture continues to remain weak. As such, the Indian benchmark indices can fall more from current levels.

However, important supports are also coming up which can halt the current fall. We expect the Nifty, Sensex and Nifty Bank index to sustain above this upcoming support and reverse higher eventually.

PPIS BUY

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) snapped their three-week selling spree. The equity segment saw a net inflow of about \$402 million last week. The FPIs have to accelerate their pace of buying in order to push the benchmark indices higher.

NIFTY 50 (23,140.50)

Short-term view: The downtrend is intact. Resistance in the 23,250-23,300 region can cap the upside. A break above 23,300 is needed to get a relief rise to 23,600-23,700. But such a rise is less likely now.

Nifty looks vulnerable to break 23,000 and fall to 22,600-22,500. The price action thereafter will need a close watch. A bounce from this support zone can take the index back up to 23,000 and even higher.

Medium-term view: Nifty is now heading towards the lower end of its 22,000-26,500 range. If Nifty fails to bounce back from around 22,500, then an extended fall to 22,000 is a possibility.

For now, we retain our positive bias for the Nifty to bounce back anywhere from the 22,500-22,000 region. Such a rise will keep the broader sideways range intact and take the Nifty higher to 25,000-26,000 in the medium term.

It will also keep our long-term bullish view of seeing a breakout above 26,500 and a rise to 28,000 and 30,000.

A decisive break below 22,000 is needed to negate our bullish view. That would need some strong negative trigger. If that happens, 21,700 and 21,200 can be seen on the downside initially.

NIFTY BANK (55,580.40)

Short-term view: Immediate support is at 55,175. If the Nifty Bank index manages to sustain



INDEX OUTLOOK. Crucial supports are coming up which can halt the fall and trigger a reversal

Nifty 50: Extended fall



NEAR-TERM RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 23,300
- Sensex: 74,800
- Nifty Bank: 57,000

at 73,400 mentioned last week is holding well. But strong resistance in the 74,600-74,800 region can cap the upside if the Sensex goes up from here. So, Sensex remains vulnerable to break 73,400 and extend the fall to 71,600.

To avoid this fall, a strong rise above 74,800 has to be seen from current levels. If that happens, a rise to 76,000 is possible. Such a rise will give some relief and turn the sentiment positive.

Medium-term view: The region between 72,000 and 71,000 is a very strong support which can halt the current fall.

We expect the Sensex to bounce back anywhere from this broad 72,000-71,000 support zone and go back up to 80,000 initially. That in turn will keep the 71,000-86,000 sideways range intact.

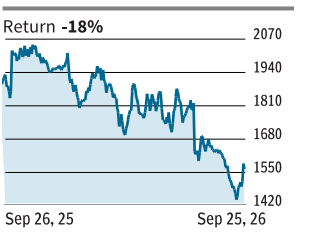
As long as the Sensex stays above 71,000, the long-term bullish view will also remain intact. So, eventually, we can look

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company (₹1,554)

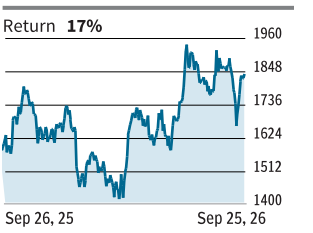
Forms a morning star pattern



This set-up has formed just around the support at ₹1,450. This indicates a bullish trend reversal. We anticipate a rally to ₹1,900 in the coming months. Buy now at ₹1,554 and ₹1,470. Place stop-loss at ₹1,380. When the stock moves up to ₹1,750, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,650. On a rally to ₹1,830, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,790. Book profits at ₹1,900.

Oberoi Realty (₹1,850.05)

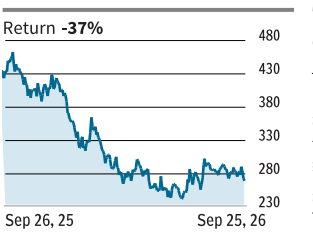
Set to rally



The stock is expected to breach the resistance at ₹1,970 and set off for a rally to ₹2,300 in the medium-term. That said, we might see a minor dip in price to ₹1,730 before the breakout of the hurdle at ₹1,970. Buy at ₹1,850 and ₹1,730. Place stop-loss at ₹1,600. On a rally to ₹2,100 and ₹2,220, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,980 and ₹2,180, respectively. Exit at ₹2,300.

Swiggy (₹264)

Rebound expected



break out of the resistance at ₹300. The stock is likely to appreciate to ₹370 in about a year. Traders can go long now at ₹264 and accumulate at ₹250. Place stop-loss at ₹230. When the price rises to ₹310, revise the stop-loss to ₹285. On a rally to ₹350, raise the stop-loss to ₹335. Book profits at ₹370.

US 10Yr Yield: 6% ahead

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Bullish chart pattern indicates more upside

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The US 10Yr Treasury yield surged to a high of 5.23 per cent before closing the week at 5.17 per cent. That in turn took the dollar index to a high of 101.40. The index has closed the week at 101.05. The US equities have also ended in green in spite of a strong surge in the yields.

The Dow Jones Industrial Average managed to recover the intra-week loss and close marginally higher. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite Index on the other hand, after opening the week with a gap-up, sustained higher all through the week. The Dow Jones was up 0.28 per cent for the week. The S&P 500 and NASDAQ Composite index rose 1.21 per cent and 2.06 per cent, respectively for the week.

Will the surge in US Treasury yields continue? Can the equity markets also sustain higher amid higher yields? Here is an analysis.

DOW JONES (51,834.17)

The fall to 51,200-51,100 mentioned last week happened as expected. The Dow Jones touched a low of 51,129 and has bounced back from there. The outlook remains negative. Any rise above 52,000 if seen can be capped at 52,500 or 52,800.

We expect the index to fall back and break below 51,000 eventually. This break can happen either from here itself or after a corrective rise to 52,500-52,800. Such a break can drag the Dow Jones lower to 50,000-49,500 in the coming weeks.

After this fall, there are good chances for the Dow Jones to reverse higher and see a fresh rise.

S&P 500 (7,743.42)

The index has risen well above the expected level of 7,720. That keeps intact the broader bullish view. Support is in the 7,700-7,680 region. Intermediate resistance is around 7,780.

We expect the S&P 500 Index to breach this hurdle and rise to



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

STRONG DOLLAR

The dollar index can rise to 102-103 on a break above 101.50

wards 7,850-7,870 in the coming weeks.

The price action thereafter will need a close watch. A downward reversal thereafter can take the index down to 7,800 and lower. But a break above 7,870 will clear the way for 8,100.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (27,068.72)

The index has risen well breaking above the resistance at 26,700. The chances of breaking above 27,350 and a rise to 28,200 or 28,500 is high now.

This 28,200-28,500 is a strong resistance zone that can halt the upmove. A reversal from this resistance zone can take the NASDAQ Composite Index down to 27,000 initially. An eventual break below 27,000 can then drag it down to 25,000.

So, we reiterate that as the index moves up towards 28,000, the sentiment should turn more cautious rather than becoming overly bullish.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The rise to 101.30 in the dollar index (101.05) happened last

for a breakout above 86,000 and a fresh rally to 90,000 and 94,000 in the long term.

A break below 71,000 and a subsequent fall below 70,000 is needed to negate our bullish view.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,437)

Failure to get a strong follow-through rise has dragged the Nifty Midcap 150 index lower last week. The crucial support level of 22,100-22,000 can be tested this week. The price action thereafter will need a close watch.

A bounce from the 22,100-22,000 can take the index up to 22,500-23,000 again. But a break below 22,000 can drag the Nifty Midcap 150 index down to 21,700. Failure to rise back above 22,000 thereafter can keep the index under pressure to see 21,000 on the downside.

However, there is no major change in the broader bullish outlook. We retain our long-term bullish view to see 26,000-26,500 and 28,000 on the upside.

A fall even to 21,000 mentioned above will only delay this long-term rally and will not negate it.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,158.90)

The support at 18,000 is continuing to hold well. The fall from the high of 18,418 last week touched a low of 18,048 and then has risen back slightly again. On the charts, the short-term picture looks slightly weak. So, there are chances to break 18,000 this week. Such a break can drag the Nifty Smallcap 250 index down to 17,800 or even 17,500.

The region between 17,500 and 17,400 is a strong support zone. A fall below 17,400 is less likely. As such, a bounce from the 17,500-17,400 support zone can take the index back up to 18,000 and higher.

That in turn will keep the broader bullish view intact to see 22,500-23,000 and 24,000-24,500 on the upside in the long term.

This rally will get delayed if a break below 17,400 happens. In that case, 16,800-16,600 can be seen on the downside.



Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



Tamil



TECH QUERY

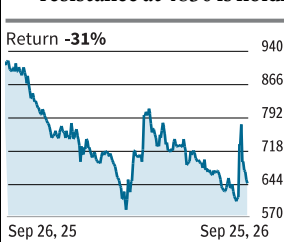


GURUMURTHY K, bl. research bureau

I have Tata Chemicals shares bought at ₹782. What is the outlook? Can I accumulate now?

Dinesh K Vishnoi

Tata Chemicals (₹644): The trend is down since October 2024. The recent price action indicates that the resistance at ₹830 is holding very well. That in turn keeps

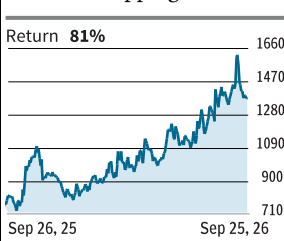


the broader downtrend intact. Support is at ₹580. The stock can break this support and fall to ₹470 in the coming months. A bounce thereafter can take the price higher to ₹700 or even ₹800. In case the price declines below ₹580, then there is a danger of seeing

What is the outlook for Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL)? I bought this stock at ₹1,160.

Sachin

CPCL (₹1,376): The broader trend is up and strong. Within that, the stock touched a high of ₹1,677 and has been dropping from there. A corrective fall to



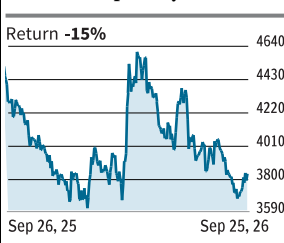
₹1,250-₹1,230 or even ₹1,160 is possible in the short term. But thereafter the price can reverse higher. That fresh leg of rally will have the potential to target ₹1,850. Keep a stop-loss at ₹1,070 and hold stock. If you have the risk-appetite, then consider accumulating on dips at

₹1,270 and ₹1,190. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,380 when the price goes up to ₹1,540. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,560 and ₹1,690 when the share price touches ₹1,640 and ₹1,760, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,830.

I purchased Avenue Supermarts (DMart) at ₹4,100. What is the long-term outlook?

Snehashish Ghosh

Avenue Supermarts (₹3,830): The stock has been broadly oscillating between ₹3,300 and ₹4,900 over the last couple of years. The share price has been coming

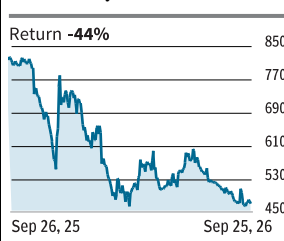


down within that now. A fall to ₹3,500-₹3,450 looks likely in the short term. A strong bounce thereafter can take the share price of Avenue Supermarts higher to ₹4,600-₹4,800, again. An extended rise to ₹5,100 is also a possibility that cannot be ruled out. Keep a stop-loss at ₹3,210 and hold the stock. Accumulate the stock when the price drops to ₹3,500. Move the stop-loss up to ₹3,650 when the price goes up to ₹4,180. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹4,220 and ₹4,530 when the share price touches ₹4,430 and ₹4,750. Exit the stock at ₹4,800. In case the share price declines breaking below ₹3,300, then adhere to the stop-loss and exit.

I have Shakti Pumps India shares. My purchase price is ₹580. What is the long-term target for this stock?

Ummachan Thomas

Shakti Pumps India (₹467): The stock has tumbled over 65 per cent after recording a high of ₹1,387 in January 2025. There is no sign of a reversal yet. The price



action since April indicates the struggle to get a sustained rise above ₹600. That keeps the danger alive of the price breaking below ₹430, the next important support. If that happens, the price can tumble towards ₹300 or even lower. Even if the price bounces back from

around ₹430, a sustained rise above ₹600 is needed to turn the outlook positive. Only then a rise to ₹700-₹800 will come into the picture. But such a strong rise looks less likely as of now. So, it is better to accept the loss and exit the stock now.

Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

BANDU'S PICKS	These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner Brij Lal Dhimani
	1 DLF	Last week's winning stock Action Construction Equipment
	2 GNFC	Closing price (Sep 18) ₹1,229.25
	3 Welspun Corp	Closing price (Sep 25) ₹1,227.55
	4 HBL Engineering	Return: -0.14 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.5 and 0.9 per cent respectively last week. BSE Realty gained the most by 3.4 per cent, followed by BSE Consumer Durables 1.3 per cent and BSE FMCG 1 per cent. BSE Teck and BSE IT declined by 2.6 and 1.7 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	19.6	19.6	35.1	13.4	50.8	60.4	32.4	45.1	18.5	17.4	11.3	31.3	11.2	39.6	19.1
P/BV	2.8	4.0	7.2	2.2	14.8	16.8	7.2	8.1	5.6	3.3	1.5	4.8	2.2	5.4	7.7
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.1	1.0	0.7	0.5	0.6	1.0	0.4	1.0	0.4	2.3	1.2	2.0	0.5	1.8
Weekly Return (%)	-0.9 ▼	-0.5 ▼	-0.9 ▼	-1.1 ▼	-1.2 ▼	1.3 ▲	1.0 ▲	0.3 ▲	-1.7 ▼	0.3 ▲	-0.5 ▼	-1.5 ▼	-0.3 ▼	3.4 ▲	-2.6 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-4.9 ▼	-4.8 ▼	-7.3 ▼	-3.6 ▼	-4.2 ▼	-6.8 ▼	-3.6 ▼	1.4 ▲	-8.0 ▼	-2.8 ▼	-2.8 ▼	-2.9 ▼	-3.5 ▼	-5.3 ▼	-8.1 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-7.0 ▼	-9.0 ▼	-0.3 ▼	1.4 ▲	9.2 ▲	2.6 ▲	-14.3 ▼	17.3 ▲	-20.5 ▼	23.8 ▲	-4.3 ▼	8.0 ▲	1.7 ▲	-0.3 ▼	-15.5 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr:High	Yr:Low	
360 ONE [1]	1069.5	30.9	34.6	4.7	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-0.8	12.1	1.6	1235.7	906.2	
3M India [1]	33942.4	391.4	86.7	21.6	202606	19.0	0.4	15.7	-11.2	-0.8	47.3	0.1	138300.0	28747.3	
A B B [2]	7057.9	72.7	97.0	16.0	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-13.0	-2.5	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5	
A B Lifestyle [1]	1231.2	-29.2			202606	1.1	20.6	9.1	33.5	-2.9	2.5	2.2	150.8	77.9	
A B Real Estate [1]	444.4	36.3	16.9	2.6	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	-3.8	11.3	2.5	193.0	425.1	
Aarti Industries [5]	489.1	14.4	34.0	3.0	202606	42.5	26.5	27.0	122.2	-0.3	6.9	0.8	551.5	338.0	
ACC [1]	126.4	2.9	43.7	2.7	202606	21.1	20.9	16.2	14.2	-0.8	9.2	0.2	1771.0	524.4	
Abbott India [1]	26935.8	759.9	35.4	12.0	202606	4.3	17.1	6.3	11.2	-1.2	43.8	0.0	30598.0	251.45	
ACC [1]	1236.7	101.2	12.2	1.1	202606	-4.6	-56.3	11.5	-18.6	-2.3	11.2	0.0	1986.9	1219.0	
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	442.2	8.4	52.5	4.0	202606	67.8	64.8	47.5	45.4	1.8	8.1	3.2	476.4	195.7	
Action Const.Eq. [2]	1227.6	36.7	33.5	7.2	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	-0.2	-0.6	0.0	1267.1	146.1	
Acutas Chemical [5]	3272.0	47.2	69.4	16.2	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	140.3	-4.8	32.2	0.0	3785.0	804.7	
Adani Energy Sol [1]	1339.4	23.9	56.1	5.7	202606	42.4	124.2	20.9	21.8	-5.3	9.5	1.9	1789.0	804.7	
Adani Enterp. [1]	2915.0	19.0	153.3	4.2	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	-2.8	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1733.5	
Adani Green [1]	1293.0	11.9	108.2	11.0	202606	15.6	16.6	7.2	1.0	-1.6	8.0	5.7	1631.4	767.0	
Adani Ports [2]	1784.0	97.7	30.9	4.3	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.0	-1.9	13.8	0.7	1891.7	1293.1	
Adani Power [2]	203.7	7.4	27.5	6.3	202606	34.0	42.0	6.6	14.9	-2.9	16.6	0.8	254.2	128.4	
Adani Total Gas [1]	610.8	5.7	106.3	13.8	202606	27.2	-14.2	19.8	-2.4	-7.5	14.8	0.5	859.7	43.5	
Aditya AWC [5]	10147.3	49.4	29.1	7.3	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.2	-0.4	32.2	0.0	1224.4	708.0	
Aditya Birl. Fas. [1]	49.2	-6.1		1.0	202606	10.6	20.15	11.4	-1.9	0.0	0.9	9.2	47.8	27.1	
Aditya Birla Cap [1]	390.0	14.7	26.5	2.8	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	-2.5	8.8	4.9	430.6	278.1	
Aditya Inotech [1]	3694.0	40.3	91.6	23.3	202606	89.5	322.5	51.8	214.8	10.2	28.1	0.3	4985.4	1278.9	
Aegis Logistics [1]	1367.1	35.6	38.3	7.9	202606	37.1	268.9	30.4	88.7	-3.5	16.1	0.8	1528.0	576.0	
Aeps Vopak Term [1]	287.5	2.4	117.6	21.4	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	-8.8	8.7	1.9	321.4	158.8	
Aether Industri. [1]	1768.1	18.1	97.8	9.6	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	8.5	11.6	0.1	1796.8	723.2		
Afers Infrast. [1]	252.4	5.6	45.3	1.7	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	-4.2	10.5	0.6	479.1	225.6	
Affle 3rd [2]	1577.1	33.9	46.5	6.1	202606	20.4	21.7	19.8	19.2	-1.5	16.7	0.0	2073.5	1251.9	
Agn Engineering [2]	392.06	136.0	28.8	4.6	202606	12.4	-13.3	25.5	14.7	-1.3	21.1	0.1	5933.0	5052.1	
Agri. Indus. [1]	354.8	90.8	39.1	9.8	202606	24.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	-0.5	31.8	0.7	379.0	2335.0	
Alkem Lab [2]	5270.0	190.6	27.7	4.6	202606	10.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	-4.2	-0.7	0.1	5930.0	5048.1	
Allied Blenders [2]	715.2	8.0	89.7	12.0	202606	6.1	13.0	8.0	-7.1	9.9	18.3	0.6	753.6	382.7	
Alkerm Industries [1]	7.5	1.5	5.0	1.1	202606	11.5	1.4	1.6	1.6	-1.6	1.5	0.0	1.5	1.1	
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	792.3	39.9	19.9	1.8	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	-4.2	11.7	0.0	102.25	671.5	
Amber Enterp. [1]	6961.5	56.1	124.1	5.6	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	-0.3	10.6	0.7	8970.0	5404.0	
Ambruja Cements [2]	384.8	19.2	20.0	1.6	202606	27.7	29.1	7.1	5.7	-2.0	6.7	0.0	588.6	379.6	
Amrutha Bathi Ws [1]	1215.6	28.0	75.9	3.3	202606	17.5	3.8	22.7	45.2	-4.8	23.8	0.1	2367.0	135.9	
Anant Raj [2]	617.1	16.1	38.4	3.8	202606	6.6	18.9	17.0	25.7	1.8	12.0	0.1	741.1	403.0	
Angel One [1]	288.0	11.3	25.5	4.3	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	-0.4	14.8	1.0	360.2	208.9	
Anthem Bioscienc [2]	874.4	10.5	83.0	16.2	202606	-22.6	-11.7	-2.1	17.6	-6.4	29.3	0.0	977.0	579.5	
Apac India [1]	1781.3	29.9	68.7	2.3	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.7	-1.9	12.0	0.1	2126.2	659.2	
Apac Apollo Tubes [2]	2206.0	44.7	49.8	11.6	202606	67.7	10.9	10.6	53.4	-2.8	30.6	0.1	2300.9	1653.0	
Apollo Hospitals [5]	8889.9	146.3	60.3	13.5	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	-1.4	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6680.4	
Apollo Tyres [1]	400.1	33.6	11.9	1.5	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	-2.8	13.4	0.3	540.3	365.4	
Apurva Value Hou. [2]	244.6	19.7	12.4	2.4	202606	15.4	20.0	23.3	23.3	-2.9	15.4	1.6	333.2	145.0	
Ashok India Gas [1]	960.0	17.5	54.8	3.2	202606	142.165.4	9.3	37.0	0.2	-11.2	107.3	72.5	1.2	1073.0	77.5
Ashok Leyland [1]	159.0	6.4	25.0	6.6	202606	11.7	0.8	16.4	17.1	-2.3	13.8	4.3	215.4	134.2	
Asian Paints [1]	2445.0	59.8	48.1	11.0	202606	17.9	40.0	9.9	26.7	1.7	25.9	0.2	2985.5	2116.0	
Asian Paints [1]	2445.0	59.8	48.1	11.0	202606	17.9	40.0	9.9	26.7	1.7	25.9	0.2	2985.5	2116.0	
Astral [1]	1396.0	22.7	63.3	14.6	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	12.2	-2.0	0.0	0.0	1768.0	1311.9	
Ather Energy [1]	1497.0	-9.7	14.6	202606	88.8	128.5	67.2	52.4	-7.0	0.0	0.4	0.0	1741.9	535.0	
Atul [1]	6075.7	270.2	22.5	2.9	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	-1.9	14.9	0.0	7198.2	5563.0	
AU Small Finance [1]	1010.0	38.1	26.7	3.9	202606	21.1	37.0	17.3	30.8	-2.4	0.0	0.0	1744.7	719.5	
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	771.3	1.3	58.7	1.6	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	-1.4	12.4	0.2	1739.6	186.9	
Avenue Invest [1]	559.4	24.7	22.6	3.2	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	0.0	13.6	0.2	683.5	40.0	
Avenue Super [1]	383.0	46.9	8.1	10.2	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	2.5	17.2	0.1	464.95	3528.7	
AWG Agri Busine. [1]	184.2	9.0	20.4	2.3	202606	17.5	-48.2	16.7	2.3	-1.5	17.1	0.2	282.9	117.5	
Axis Bank [2]	1220.0	89.2	13.7	1.7	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	-1.7	0.0	0.0	1418.3	112.5	

BHEL [2]	419.2	7.0	60.0	5.6	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	-3.4	5.6	0.3	446.8	229.7
BPCIL	307.6	35.7	8.6	1.3	202606	34.4	-154.5	12.3	-11.7	0	24.9	0.6	39.1	26.6
Bajaj Auto	11340.0	428.9	26.4	8.0	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	-1.4	28.4	0.4	12470.0	8490.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	99.50	32.9	30.2	5.4	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	-3.1	10.9	3.8	117.7	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1769.0	64.9	27.2	3.6	202606	19.4	12.3	15.1	9.3	-4.4	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [1]	10891.9	795.8	13.7	1.7	202606	21.5	32.2	30.2	27.3	-3.4	12.6	0.1	13250.0	8597.9
Bajaj Housing	83.2	3.2	25.7	3.1	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	-2.7	8.8	4.4	113.6	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2183.1	72.7	30.0	3.9	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-3.7	10.9	0.4	2775.0	1971.0
Balrampur Chini [1]	686.0	17.5	39.1	3.2	202606	6.1	14.4	15.0	11.3	-2.0	9.3	0.7	781.0	393.4
Bank of Baroda [2]	235.3	42.9	5.5	0.7	202606	8.8	68.2	4.9	14.1	0.2	0.0	0.0	32.5	232.1
Bank of India [1]	138.0	25.9	5.3	0.8	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	-1.5	0.0	0.0	178.5	116.0
Bank of Maha	84.7	9.8	8.6	1.9	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	3.3	0.0	0.0	94.5	53.8
Bata India [1]	628.8	13.5	46.5	5.1	202606	3.9	15.9	19.7	-1.7	0.9	12.6	0.9	1263.9	606.6
Baycor Crop Sol.	3716.0	162.9	22.8	5.6	202606	-4.2	15.4	-2.8	23.6	-1.9	12.0	0.1	5333.0	370.9
Bayer Ind Sci [5]	248.1	5.3	47.0	3.5	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	3.2	14.4	0.6	268.0	148.2
BEML Ltd [1]	2035.7	21.4	95.0	5.8	202606	29.3	-142.1	12.8	-40.3	-4.6	5.7	0.1	226.8	136.1
Bergar Paints [1]	458.3	10.5	43.7	7.7	202606	12.0	18.2	5.2	5.1	-0.1	21.3	0.1	594.2	393.9
Bharat Electronics [1]	121.3	8.4	16.7	2.3	202606	12.5	8.1	11.3	24.9	-1.2	10.2	0.1	392.3	204.9
Bharat Forge [2]	2005.0	20.7	96.9	8.5	202606	18.7	-57.6	17.5	-1.3	1.5	1.7	0.7	2293.0	1179.4
Bharti Airtel [5]	1786.0	51.0	35.0	6.3	202606	18.4	41.6	19.6	9.7	-4.2	19.3	0.6	1714.7	1745.0
Bharat Hexacom [5]	1482.2	37.0	40.1	10.3	202606	19.9	23.2	7.9	28.6	-3.9	20.5	1.6	2157.0	143.0
Bhilai Steel [2]	573.2	4.4	55.0	8.9	202606	13.1	14.6	29.2	1.2	1.2	76.3	5.3	622.0	139.0
BillionsBricks [2]	197.3	3.9	48.2	12.2	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	-2.7	27.2	0.1	227.0	112.0
Biocon [5]	281.5	4.5	85.1	1.8	202606	9.8	287.2	10.1	103.2	-1.0	3.8	0.6	474.0	337.2
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	77.4	21.3	12.8	1.9	202606	7.4	51.3	1.3	16.1	-2.2	20.0	0.0	473.8	277.0
BLIS Interst. [1]	224.3	17.1	13.1	3.4	202606	25.3	11.2	31.8	24.9	-1.0	33.8	0.2	203.2	118.0
Blue Bird Express	476.0	18.4	26.1	1.8	202606	18.1	5.0	15.0	15.0	-0.9	19.6	0.2	239.2	243.5
BLS Star [2]	175.0	25.7	61.0	9.8	202606	13.3	-21.0	5.9	-0.9	0.7	0.2	20.2	235.2	143.7
Bombay	4810.0	801.2	6.0	9.6	202606	22.0	5.2	13.6	6.5	0.6	21.0	0.0	0.94629528650	0.0
Boonshree Solut.	180.8	-2.0	2.0	2.0	202606	13.1	141.4	11.7	24.2	5.0	0.0	0.0	389.1	116.0
Brigade Inds. Enpr.	20.0	20.8	28.7	2.0	202606	-12.9	-16.1	4.8	-9.6	-3.7	10.7	0.0	801.6	461.3
Britannia Inds [1]	4939.0	108.4	45.7	23.3	202606	9.5	13.6	7.5	19.7	1.5	15.3	0.3	6299.0	4883.4

Much-needed course correction

BL EXPLAINER. IRDAI’s consultation paper announces a strong intent to overhaul insurance distribution

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

IRDAI released a public consultation paper titled “Recalibrating economics of insurance distribution” on September 23, 2026. In the following two days, two listed insurance aggregators and distributors cumulatively lost around ₹33,000 crore in market capitalisation. This should point to the scope of the changes proposed in the paper. Even as the paper discussed changes in the insurance, distribution and regulation, policyholders get a rare chance to peak behind the curtain to assess how the industry serves their needs.

However, policyholders should note that the paper only proposed changes, which after a feedback process (open till October 25) will be reviewed by the regulator. The following discussion should not be construed as a future change in insurance, but only as proposals under discussion and evaluation.

What is the objective behind IRDAI’s consultation paper, “Recalibrating economics of insurance distribution”?

To improve insurance outcomes for all stakeholders including policyholders, insurers and distributors. The paper stresses on the fact that insurance premiums have barely kept pace with GDP growth in the last 10 years and new lives covered have only stagnated every year, when the need was for high growth to fill the protection gap. The paper focuses primarily on distribution and expenses of insurers impacting outcomes and identifies ways to overcome them.

How are operational expenses of insurers affecting policyholders?

The paper makes a stark observation that distributor remuneration now accounts for nearly 27 per cent of first-year premium in life insurance corporate agency channels. This is among several ratios showing the high impact of distribution costs. In another illustration, it highlights that between FY23 and FY25, premiums grew 28 per cent in the life insurance segment, the distributor remuneration grew 125 per cent, while it was 37 per cent versus 173 per cent in general insurance (GI).

In the several categories of general insurance, the average commissions in FY25 accounted for 24 per cent/24 per cent/13 per cent/12 per cent for motor, travel, property and health insurance,



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Maximum commission limits as percentage of premium

All units in percentages

Life insurance					
Entity	Premium payment term	Distribution Entities		Agents	
		First year	Renewal	First year	Renewal
Individual (Par and non-par)	Below 5 years	5	2	6.25	5
	5 years	10	2	12.5	5
	10 years and above	20	3	25	5
Individual	Term multi year	25	7.5	30	10
Group	Term multi year	5	5	7.5	7.5
Pension	Single premium	0.5	NA	0.75	NA
Pension	Multi year	5	5	6.5	5

General insurance					
Motor insurance					
Insurance	Vehicle type	Distribution entities		Agents	Garages
Third Party	New	0		2.5	NA
Own Damage	New	5		10	NA
Third Party	Old	2.5		5	2.5
Own Damage	Old	10		15	10
Health insurance					
Insurance	Nature	Distribution entities		Agents	Hospitals
Individual	First time	15		20	5
	Renewal	5		10	NA
	Porting	5		10	NA
Group	First time	2.5 with max of ₹100 lakhs	5 with max of ₹100 lakhs	1 with max of ₹100 lakhs	
	Renewal				
	Porting				

Source: IRDAI Consultation paper

respectively.

With such high expenses, even before risk coverage begins in earnest, the policyholder is experiencing a shrinking risk pool, which is supposed to pay for the insured event; a lower return for a return-based product like par or non-par life insurance policy or a higher premium to cover a risk in general or term life insurance.

The paper notes that the insurance industry is turning into a high-cost-low-inclusion model that is reliant on high commissions to generate volumes.

Product innovation, service parameters, operating and distributing efficiency, claim experience and price-based competition are being relegated to a secondary tier in insurance, that is increasingly reliant on distribution economies.

The industry is also not facilitating economies of scale, which is crucial for insurance maths to work and further expand. The insurers are not able to expand operations with internal accruals as expenses-led growth leaves little return. This impacts competition and further narrows distribution

KEY POINTS

- Insurance industry while growing has not addressed protection gaps
- Paper focuses on restricting high costs to improve insurance penetration
- Five-year glide path towards expenses limits of 12.5 per cent for life insurers and 20 per cent for general insurers

channels to consolidate their position.

What is Expense of Management framework? What did the 2023 reforms change in the framework?

The paper identifies the regulator’s failings as well. IRDAI proposed Expenses of Management (EoM) Framework 2023 that was aimed to improve outcomes by prescribing an overall expenses limit, leaving product-wise compensation to insurers. For instance, GI expenses were to be capped at 30 per cent of Gross Written Premium, which is direct premium plus reinsurance premiums, allowing a larger headroom for expenses compared to a calculation based on direct premium. This was implemented from FY23. But commissions as a percentage of premiums (direct) have been rising since the implementation of this framework and are at a high currently. Total expense as percentage of gross premium declined from 21.3/30.3 per cent in FY15 for private life and private GI respectively to 16.5 per cent in FY21 for private life and 25.1 per cent for private GI in FY19. Post FY23 EoM changes, this ratio again increased and now stands at 20.2 for private life and 32.1 for private GI.

What are the prescriptive limits on commissions for different insurance segments, lines of business and distribution channels suggested in the paper?

The paper proposes a five-year glide path towards EoM limits of 12.5 per cent for life insurers and 20 per cent for general insurers. But with the lessons from EoM 2023, the regulator has now proposed a detailed commission structure that is micro-specific to product, purchase frequency,

channel and other factors. Even difficulty of selling is considered in prescribing maximum commissions. For instance, third-party motor insurance, which is mandated by the government and hence easier to sell, is prescribed no commission for distribution entities, lending entities or garages and 2.5 per cent for agents and associates. Similarly, insurance sales in smaller towns across categories is allowed a 10 per cent additional commission.

The table illustrates prominent products and maximum commission prescribed.

How will these proposed changes benefit the policy holders?

First, if commissions and expenses are capped, this translates to a higher risk pool, which benefits policyholders. This depends on the regulator notifying the changes and insurance companies, based on their competitive outlook, reviewing premiums and returns. At the industry end, the paper prioritises increased competition, allowing for non-insurance sales, eliminating regulatory arbitrage for similar services, easing capital requirements and setting market infrastructure institutions. The latter is a way for insurers to form a marketing entity and share costs and has the potential to significantly impact the industry, if taken up.

The paper discusses many other smaller changes apart from pricing — bundled products, for instance. Home loans and vehicle sales are bundled with insurance — putting policyholders in a restricted position with or without explicit information. The paper proposes that the policyholder should be informed, not be bound by the package, paid separately as different transaction, and even allowed to secure home or motor insurance elsewhere if asked.

The paper also suggests ways of improved decision-making by policyholders with a one-page information summary, pricing and relevant details provided by insurers even before buying and without providing any personal details. Also, the long-standing issue of claims settlement ratio in health insurance which apparently is at a high 95-99 per cent, may not reveal the actual underlying situation as even claims that are rejected/reputed are included in this ratio. This proposed to be made more clear by focusing on claims served on a cash basis and not volumes.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	Sep 14
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.75	6.25	6	Aug 10
Indian Bank	6.2	6.65	6.6	6.05	Aug 04
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.85	6.1	5.95	Jun 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.55	6.1	6	Aug 04

INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.5	6.5	6.5	Sep 22
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.45	7.45	7.25	Jun 20
CSB Bank	6	7.1	7	5.75	Sep 05
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	Jun 16
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Aug 04
Dhanlaxmi Bank	7	7.1	6.5	7.25	Sep 02
Federal Bank	6	6.65	6.5	6.7	Aug 17
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Aug 19
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Sep 25
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.55	Sep 21
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.1	7.1	6.75	Sep 01
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jul 24
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.05	6.75	Sep 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.65	6.65	6.4	Sep 23
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 08
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	Jun 19
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02

SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	8	Jun 16
ESAF Small Finance Bank	6	7.75	8	6	Aug 17
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	8	7.77	Aug 06
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.8	8.1	8.25	Sep 24
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.55	7.25	7.8	Sep 01
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 01

*Data as on respective banks’ website on 25 Sep 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)	
		Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	Jul 1 - Sep 30, 2026
Post Office Savings Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9
	2 year	7.0	7.0
	3 year	7.1	7.1
	5 year	7.5	7.5
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5*	7.5*
Sukanya Samridhhi Yojana		8.2	8.2

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on June 30, 2026 #Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

ALERTS.

Advantage SBI Card on SBI YONO

SBI Card has announced the launch of Advantage SBI Card on SBI YONO, introducing a seamless digital journey that enables customers to avail a secured credit card backed by a fixed deposit. The end-to-end digital journey for secured credit cards on SBI YONO, further strengthens customer’s access to credit through a seamless and convenient digital experience. Customers can apply for four secured Advantage SBI Card — SBI Card Elite, SBI Card Prime, SimplyClick SBI Card, and SimplySAVE SBI Card on SBI YONO. The initiative combines the security of a fixed deposit with the convenience and benefits of a credit card.

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- PERSONAL
- CHANGE OF NAME
- I, PRAKASH, S/o ARUMUGAM, holder of Passport No. P7528582, Date of Birth 02-06-1978, residing at 377/A, Kallanatham Road , Penyar Nagar, North Katukottai, Melnarayappanur (Village), Chinnasalem Taluk, Kallakurichi District, shall henceforth be known as SEKAR (New Name), Old Name: PRAKASH / New Name: SEKAR
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SIMPLYPUT.

Central bank stances

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

At the gym, teammates Anjana and Gayathri are on the treadmill. The conversation veers towards monetary policy.

Gayathri: Hey Anjana, did you observe that central banks around the world have started hiking interest rates? Do you think our RBI also would hike the repo rate?

Anjana: Seems likely, Gayathri. The war in Iran doesn’t seem to stop anytime soon and inflation is at 4.8 per cent. The market is already pricing in a rate hike.

Gayathri: How so?

Anjana: The yield on the two-year G-Sec, which is a good leading indicator of central bank policy rates, is already up over 50 bps in the last 10 trading sessions or so. We will get to know for ourselves from the horse’s mouth on October 7, when the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting concludes. Rather than the policy rate action, I’m looking forward more to whether the RBI changes its current neutral stance.

Gayathri: Hold on. I understand policy rate actions. But what is this ‘stance’ by the way? Can you explain?

Anjana: Sure. When the RBI communicates its stance to the public, it is trying to let them know how it thinks about the trajectory of interest rates, going forward.

Gayathri: I know there is an accommodative stance. What are the others?

Anjana: Indeed. Broadly, there is an accommodative stance, there is a neutral stance and a tightening stance. The RBI currently has a neutral stance.

Gayathri: Let’s start with the accommodative stance first.

Anjana: All right. When the RBI shifts to an accommodative stance, it means that given the absence of any shock, the RBI will look to either cut the repo rate or keep it unchanged.

I believe you know that one of the key roles of a central bank is to balance growth and inflation. When conditions are such that the economy is struggling to grow or when there are threats to growth and at the same time when inflation is not a concern, the RBI could take an accommodative stance. Cut interest rates to boost growth.

Gayathri: Can you point to an instance when the RBI took an accommodative stance?

Anjana: Back in June 2019, when growth had moderated, the RBI shifted to an accommodative stance from a neutral stance. Real GDP growth for FY19 had slowed to about 6.5 per cent from around 8.25 per cent, a couple years ago. Inflation at 3.2 per cent, was under RBI’s targeted 4 per cent. So, it made sense for RBI to assume an accommodative stance. In the same meeting, the MPC resolved to cut the repo rate at 6 per cent to 5.75 per cent. The rate cuts continued into 2020, coinciding with the pandemic, eventually to settle at 4 per cent, to support growth.

Even recently, in April 2025, on the back of Trump’s tariffs, RBI shifted to an accommodative stance. With inflation under 4 per cent, growth became the central bank’s focus. In the April and June MPC meetings, the RBI cut the repo rate at 6.25 per cent by 75 bps to 5.5 per cent.

Gayathri: I see. What is a neutral stance, then?

Anjana: When a central bank takes a neutral stance, it means



REUTERS

that monetary policy is neither focusing on growth nor on inflation. Kind of balancing the growth-inflation dynamic. Also, a neutral stance indicates that the central bank is neither looking to hike rates nor looking to cut them. Its moves will then be dictated by incoming data.

Gayathri: You mentioned that RBI currently has a neutral stance, right? When did it move to a neutral stance?

Anjana: It was in June 2025. RBI had quickly cut the repo rate by 100 bps since February, to 5.5 per cent. It deemed this rate appropriate for balancing growth and inflation and shifted its focus to incoming data to guide policy moves in the future.

However, inflation from June’s 2.1 per cent had dipped sharply to 0.25 per cent and 0.71 per cent in October and November 2025. Reading the incoming data and assessing it to be well below its 4-per cent target, the RBI cut repo rate by 25 bps again in its December policy.

Gayathri: That’s great. When does the RBI shift to a tightening stance?

Anjana: This is similar to the

accommodative stance. The only difference here is that the trajectory of rates is up and not down. That is, when the RBI shifts to a tightening stance, it communicates that, in the absence of shocks, it will look to take the repo rate higher or keep it unchanged. Inflation spiralling out of control and an overheated economy generally push RBI to take this stance.

Gayathri: Any real-life instances where RBI took a tightening stance?

Anjana: After the sub-prime mortgage crisis, global central banks had pumped massive liquidity into the banking system to recover from a recession. The aftermath in India manifested in inflation (measured by CPI-general for industrial workers with 2001 as the base year) hitting 16.2 per cent in January 2010. The RBI had shifted to a tightening stance by October 2009. What followed was a series of rate hikes — from 4.75 per cent then to 8.5 per cent by October 2011.

Gayathri: What was the case in 2022?

Anjana: By April 2022, liquid-

ity infused to the tune of about ₹17 lakh crore to take on the pandemic, had done its job. Some of it had been withdrawn, leaving the system still with a surplus liquidity overhang of about ₹8.5 lakh crore. This was unhealthy, as it risked stoking inflation — especially against the backdrop of rising energy costs due to the Russia-Ukraine war. Therefore, the RBI while remaining accommodative to support growth, decided to ‘withdraw accommodation’ or gradually remove the surplus liquidity from the system.

The repo rate was hiked from 4 per cent to 6.5 per cent by February 2023. This was to fight inflation which was above 6 per cent for most of 2022 and to keep the rupee from falling when other central banks were hiking rates. The RBI probably didn’t want to call it a tightening stance to not shock a fragile recovery post the pandemic shock.

Gayathri: Isn’t today’s situation like 2022 to some extent — rates to be hiked to fight inflation and excess liquidity from FCNR (B) flows are to be absorbed at the same time?

Anjana: You are right. Banks are said to have mobilised over \$130 billion in FCNR(B) deposits, which is roughly ₹13 lakh crore. However, the RBI is already managing the excess liquidity through bond sales and VRRR (variable rate reverse repo) auctions. Plus, inflation at 4.82 per cent isn’t yet at extreme levels as in 2022. Even if they hike rates, the intensity of tightening may not be as it was in 2022-23. The RBI might even hold its neutral stance.

But that’s only my guess and it is this uncertainty that makes the upcoming MPC meet all the more compelling to watch.



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	104.6	80206	1.1	0.7	-5.7	9.8	9.8	12.3	0.32
*****	Invesco India Largecap	70.4	2021	1.8	0.7	1.2	12.3	9.2	11.8	0.28
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	86.8	54134	1.2	0.6	-5.4	9.8	11.4	12.8	0.38
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	215.2	2641	1.7	0.7	-1.4	10.0	8.6	11.6	0.26
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	57.9	17092	1.4	0.5	-5.1	8.7	7.0	12.0	0.20
*****	JM Large Cap	149.8	394	2.1	0.8	-2.0	8.9	8.7	10.2	0.26
*****	SBI Large Cap	90.7	55140	1.2	0.7	-1.6	8.3	7.8	10.7	0.24
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	502.5	29711	1.4	0.8	-4.5	8.6	7.7	10.5	0.23
***	Bandhan Large Cap	76.1	2180	1.7	0.8	-1.1	11.2	8.5	11.4	0.25
***	DSP Large Cap	440.5	7101	1.5	0.8	-6.5	9.6	7.7	9.5	0.22
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	81.3	1434	1.8	0.6	-2.8	8.4	7.7	11.3	0.22
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	980.3	7490	1.5	0.9	-4.3	8.6	6.6	9.6	0.19
***	HDFC Large Cap	1091.9	39933	1.3	0.8	-3.8	8.1	9.7	11.3	0.31
***	HSBC Large Cap	466.5	1855	1.8	1.0	-1.0	9.0	7.6	10.8	0.20
***	Kotak Large Cap	547.2	10937	1.5	0.6	-4.5	8.7	7.3	11.1	0.21
***	Mah Manu Large Cap	21.3	695	2.0	0.7	-6.8	6.4	6.1	-	0.16
***	Tata Large Cap	486.4	2656	1.7	0.8	-3.8	8.7	7.7	10.4	0.23
***	Groww Largecap	41.6	137	2.1	0.9	-3.6	8.9	7.3	9.6	0.19
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	108.2	38166	1.3	0.5	-4.1	7.3	6.2	11.3	0.17
***	Union Largecap	22.4	437	2.1	1.3	-4.8	6.5	5.8	-	0.15
***	UTI Large Cap	256.4	12189	1.5	0.8	-6.5	6.1	5.2	10.1	0.13
***	Axis Large Cap	58.5	31376	1.3	0.6	-3.6	7.8	4.1	10.9	0.08
***	LIC MF Large Cap	52.5	1385	1.8	0.9	-5.4	6.8	4.6	9.1	0.10
***	PGIM India Large Cap	322.4	538	2.1	0.8	-5.3	5.9	4.6	8.9	0.10
-	Taurus Large Cap	168.4	60	2.1	1.9	7.8	13.0	9.9	9.8	0.28

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	138.7	21020	1.4	0.4	2.8	16.4	15.0	14.4	0.47
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1011.2	33592	1.3	0.7	-0.2	14.1	14.2	14.0	0.51
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	122.7	3487	1.7	0.6	9.2	13.6	13.7	14.6	0.39
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	34.4	17320	1.4	0.5	4.8	14.0	10.4	-	0.29
*****	HDFC Large & Mid Cap	338.8	30294	1.4	0.8	-0.3	11.7	13.1	13.8	0.42
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	108.1	12387	1.5	0.5	7.1	21.4	15.2	15.6	0.43
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	180.9	6514	1.6	0.8	1.9	13.8	12.6	13.0	0.41
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	91.0	529	2.1	0.9	5.0	12.0	10.2	11.8	0.30
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	598.3	18411	1.4	0.5	-2.2	11.9	10.3	12.9	0.31
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	88.0	4942	1.6	0.5	2.5	12.5	10.9	13.5	0.34
***	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	29.3	5931	1.6	0.7	7.7	16.3	12.5	-	0.32
***	Kotak Large & Mid Cap	343.0	32325	1.3	0.5	0.4	11.9	11.8	13.7	0.35
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	152.2	45811	1.3	0.5	1.0	10.7	9.2	14.9	0.27
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1452.1	7903	1.5	0.9	-1.7	13.5	11.7	12.0	0.37
***	SBI Large & Midcap	628.3	42336	1.3	0.6	1.0	11.4	12.0	13.4	0.39
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	250.2	26331	1.4	0.5	-3.1	11.2	8.8	13.4	0.26
***	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	185.4	3622	1.6	1.1	-2.6	10.4	8.6	10.6	0.26
***	LIC MF Large & Midcap	38.0	3198	1.7	0.5	-1.0	11.9	9.4	12.6	0.29
***	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	90.2	7544	1.5	0.7	5.5	12.9	10.2	13.6	0.31
***	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	935.6	5998	1.6	0.9	4.0	10.5	6.2	10.1	0.25
***	Navi Large & Midcap	37.7	315	2.1	0.5	2.0	7.9	8.2	11.4	0.14
***	Tata Large & Mid Cap	486.4	7679	1.5	0.6	-5.4	6.0	8.0	11.2	0.22

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2010.2	113606	1.1	0.6	-1.0	14.7	15.8	14.7	0.57
*****	JM Flexi Cap	98.9	5291	1.6	0.5	0.7	13.5	13.6	14.8	0.41
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.9	147405	1.1	0.5	-4.1	12.0	10.3	16.1	0.37
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1915.9	29044	1.4	0.7	6.9	13.8	10.1	12.6	0.31
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.9	3722	1.6	0.5	0.4	12.6	10.4	13.2	0.31
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1546.2	19385	1.4	0.8	-4.7	9.8	10.2	12.1	0.32
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	231.5	6000	1.6	0.9	5.5	14.9	11.8	12.1	0.33
***	Axis Flexi Cap	27.9	13943	1.5	0.6	3.5	12.7	7.2	-	0.19
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	204.2	7508	1.5	1.0	-2.0	9.7	8.4	10.1	0.24
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	333.4	13679	1.5	0.5	-2.8	10.2	7.7	12.7	0.22
***	DSP Flexi Cap	100.7	12500	1.5	0.6	-2.1	9.7	8.0	12.4	0.21
***	Kotak Flexi Cap	82.9	56392	1.2	0.5	-2.1	10.4	9.2	11.9	0.26
***	Navi Flexi Cap	24.8	297	2.1	0.5	8.7	9.8	9.1	-	0.26
***	PGIM India Flexi Cap	36.4	5963	1.6	0.5	-0.1	9.2	6.3	12.6	0.16
***	Union Flexi Cap	51.6	2452	1.7	0.8	1.0	10.1	8.6	12.1	0.24
***	LIC MF Flexi Cap	103.1	1125	1.9	0.9	2.7	10.1	8.7	9.7	0.25
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	62.7	14160	1.4	0.7	1.9	17.1	11.6	11.8	0.32
**	SBI Flexicap	107.4	23235	1.4	0.7	-1.8	7.8	6.9	10.9	0.19
**	Tata Flexi Cap	22.9	3663	1.6	0.6	-6.3	8.4	6.9	-	0.19
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.2	131	2.1	0.8	-3.6	5.6	5.2	-	0.11
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	243.4	382	2.1	2.0	8.9	11.6	10.1	9.7	0.28
**	UTI Flexi Cap	318.6	24163	1.4	0.8	-2.4	7.4	3.4	11.0	0.06
-	Quant Flexi Cap	106.9	7364	1.5	0.6	10.2	14.3	13.1	17.8	0.36

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	289.0	3493	1.7	0.8	1.6	13.5	11.2	13.1	0.32
-	ICICI Pru Multi Cap	841.9	19538	1.4	0.8	6.7	14.8	13.5	13.5	0.44
-	Invesco India Multicap	130.0	4529	1.6	0.6	0.4	12.1	10.1	12.7	0.28
-	ITI Multi Cap	26.0	1543	1.8	0.5	11.5	15.5	12.1	-	0.34
-	Mah Manu Multi Cap	39.1	7662	1.5	0.4	11.3	15.9	13.9	-	0.40
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	294.6	56298	1.2	0.6	-2.2	12.2	15.1	14.4	0.49
-	Quant Multi Cap	659.0	7725	1.5	0.6	6.3	9.1	10.1	16.6	0.26
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	383.7	3070	1.7	0.8	0.4	11.6	10.4	13.1	0.31

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	106.3	19891	1.4	0.4	5.8	19.0	16.6	17.2	0.48
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4419.6	52271	1.2	0.6	6.8	17.1	16.6	17.1	0.50
*****	Quant Mid Cap	215.8	8056	1.5	0.7	3.7	9.6	13.6	16.6	0.38
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	204.1	108325	1.1	0.6	5.5	16.0	17.5	16.2	0.57
*****	Invesco India Midcap	194.8	15905	1.4	0.5	8.2	22.1	17.7	17.7	0.49
*****	Mah Manu Mid Cap	35.2	5406	1.6	0.5	7.1	15.6	15.6	-	0.46
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	100.9	42852	1.3	0.6	-0.9	17.5	19.2	15.7	0.53
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	108.7	2658	1.7	0.5	7.9	14.8	13.3	14.3	0.40
***	HSBC Midcap	460.8	17188	1.4	0.5	16.6	22.1	16.8	16.1	0.45
***	ICICI Pru Mid Cap	335.8	8403	1.5	0.9	12.8	20.4	15.7	15.6	0.49
***	Kotak Mid Cap	142.1	71256	1.2	0.3	3.8	16.0	15.0	16.2	0.44
***	PGIM India Midcap	65.1	11218	1.5	0.5	-0.4	10.3	8.9	14.3	0.25
***	SBI Midcap	236.7	24518	1.4	0.7	3.8	9.7	12.2	12.8	0.37
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1451.9	14863	1.4	0.8	5.2	16.7	15.4	13.4	0.46
***	Tata Mid Cap	449.9	6240	1.6	0.5	4.5	13.4	13.3	14.9	0.40
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	829.7	6966	1.6	0.9	6.1	13.7	12.4	12.4	0.37
**	Axis Midcap	119.7	35425	1.3	0.5	5.7	15.1	11.4	16.1	0.33
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2734.5	13052	1.5	0.8	0.6	14.3	12.0	13.2	0.35
**	UTI Mid Cap	306.8	12795	1.5	0.7	2.5	10.6	10.3	12.7	0.30
*	DSP Midcap	151.4	21019	1.4	0.6	2.8	13.0	10.2	12.9	0.29
*	LIC MF Midcap	30.3	392	2.1	1.2	4.8	14.7	11.5	-	0.31
*	Taurus Mid Cap	128.4	140	2.1	1.7	6.0	9.6	11.7	13.9	0.32

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Bank of India Small Cap	58.7	3307	1.7	0.4	26.1	21.0	18.3	-	0.45
*****	Quant Small Cap	290.6	35557	1.3	0.6	13.9	17.0	17.9	19.8	0.44
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	47.3	7253	1.5	0.4	8.0	14.4	15.1	-	0.43
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	47.9	15744	1.4	0.4	15.3	21.8	18.2	-	0.47

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	184.0	82580	1.1	0.5	8.8	14.8	17.7	19.8	0.47
★★★★	Union Small Cap	60.1	2667	1.7	0.8	20.8	16.5	16.1	16.2	0.41
★★★★	AXIS Small Cap	116.4	31448	1.4	0.6	9.3	14.7	14.5	17.9	0.44
★★★	Canara Robeco Small Cap	40.6	14661	1.5	0.5	5.0	11.6	13.2	-	0.37
★★★	DSP Small Cap	231.4	21659	1.4	0.7	17.6	17.2	17.0	16.0	0.45
★★★	HSBC Small Cap	91.1	19076	1.4	0.6	12.3	14.0	16.1	17.5	0.40
★★★	Kotak Small Cap	276.7	19679	1.4	0.5	6.5	11.9	11.7	15.8	0.30
★★★	LIC MF Small Cap	35.4	832	2.0	0.8	15.3	17.8	16.4	-	0.41
★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	294.7	4155	1.6	0.7	13.3	15.9	15.1	13.9	0.40
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	176.4	14746	1.5	0.8	4.4	12.3	14.5	14.0	0.38
★★	HDFC Small Cap	139.2	41891	1.3	0.6	-2.5	10.1	13.6	16.2	0.37
★★	ICICI Pru Small Cap	92.1	9821	1.5	0.7	4.8	11.3	13.0	14.9	0.40
★★	Tata Small Cap	40.1	13094	1.5	0.4	-0.3	11.7	14.2	-	0.35
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	100.2	6296	1.6	0.8	18.0	15.0	12.8	12.3	0.32
★	SBI Small Cap	183.9	42631	1.3	0.6	6.8	11.0	13.1	17.3	0.39

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %Ann	3 Month %Ann	6 Month %Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2161.7	629	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.0	6.4	6.2	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	453.7	69830	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- Axis Liquid	3137.1	63343	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.3	6.9	6.5	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3397.2	20198	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.1	6.7	6.3	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3244.9	1825	0.1	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3234.7	13194	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.7	6.4	0.60
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3388.0	6783	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.2	6.7	6.4	-
- DSP Liquid	4020.8	27920	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.8	6.4	0.60
- Edelweiss Liquid	3602.9	13272	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.9	6.5	-
- Groww Liquid	2722.6	381	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- HDFC Liquid	5522.6	71323	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- HSBC Liquid	2806.3	20975	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	416.6	62798	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3870.5	20748	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.3	6.9	6.4	-
- ITI Liquid	1461.6	52	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.8	6.3	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	76.7	1743	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.1	6.7	6.3	-
- Kotak Liquid	5687.6	49073	0.3	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5088.5	17484	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1832.6	1392	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.4	6.8	6.4	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2949.7	17359	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.7	6.3	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.8	1015	0.4	0.2	5.4	5.7	6.1	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	30.4	74	0.3	0.2	5.0	5.4	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6870.1	43125	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1560.7	6722	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.7	6.3	-
- PGIM India Liquid	366.6	1031	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.9	6.4	-
- Quant Liquid	44.3	1426	0.5	0.3	5.7	5.7	5.9	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.5	556	0.2	0.1	5.5	5.8	6.0	5.8	-
- SBI Liquid	4398.6	92192	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2481.4	9094	0.3	0.1	5.7	6.4	6.8	6.4	-
- Tata Liquid	4433.8	32370	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.7	6.4	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1366.5	1203	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.7	6.3	-
- Union Liquid	2708.8	7578	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.7	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	462.0	29218	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.8	6.4	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1512.4	743	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.2	6.7	6.3	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1479.6	10464	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- Axis Overnight	1455.8	11325	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1460.2	1160	0.1	0.0	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1400.5	109	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.5	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1443.2	852	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1423.3	737	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- DSP Overnight	1469.7	2854	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1422.6	192	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1435.4	685	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Groww Overnight	1411.9	12	0.2	0.1	4.6	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
- HDFC Overnight	4048.0	12190	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- HSBC Overnight	1432.0	4355	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1478.0	14368	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1389.6	343	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- ITI Overnight	1385.8	14	0.2	0.1	4.4	4.7	4.8	4.9	-
- JM Overnight	1391.3	148	0.1	0.1	4.6	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
- Kotak Overnight	1462.6	8618	0.2	0.1	4.7	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1419.1	732	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1418.6	77	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1406.9	1727	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	147.3	8548	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1416.0	153	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- SBI Overnight	4427.0	23407	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1455.4	1335	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- Tata Overnight	1445.3	4571	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1442.5	411	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3736.4	5648	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.5	27237	0.9	0.3	5.1	5.7	5.8	6.1	-
- Axis Arbitrage	20.1	10594	0.9	0.3	5.2	5.6	5.8	6.1	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.7	7796	0.9	0.3	5.2	5.5	5.6	5.8	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.7	134	0.9	0.4	5.1	5.5	5.3	5.7	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.2	1055	1.0	0.3	4.9	5.1	5.3	5.6	-
- DSP Arbitrage	16.0	6673	0.8	0.3	5.2	5.5	5.7	6.0	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.8	14849	0.9	0.3	4.9	5.6	5.8	6.1	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.9	25509	0.8	0.3	5.1	5.7	5.9	6.2	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.4	3288	0.8	0.2	5.4	5.6	5.7	6.1	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.9	34850	0.8	0.3	5.4	5.9	5.9	6.2	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.3	30618	0.9	0.3	5.3	5.8	5.9	6.2	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.9	63	0.8	0.2	2.6	4.8	4.6	5.7	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.9	482	0.9	0.4	5.0	5.4	5.3	5.8	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.3	75712	0.8	0.3	5.1	5.7	5.9	6.2	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.8	310	0.7	0.2	4.1	5.7	5.8	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.2	134	1.0	0.3	4.1	5.0	5.0	5.6	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	14.0	3838	0.8	0.1	5.6	5.7	5.5	6.0	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.5	17533	0.9	0.3	5.0	5.6	5.8	6.1	-
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.6	99	0.9	0.3	5.0	5.5	5.7	5.9	-
- SBI Arbitrage	36.3	47283	0.8	0.3	5.1	5.6	5.7	6.1	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.5	554	0.8	0.2	4.4	5.4	5.7	6.1	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.4	24950	0.9	0.3	5.1	5.5	5.7	6.1	-
- Union Arbitrage	15.1	221	0.9	0.3	5.3	6.1	5.9	6.1	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.7	11132	0.8	0.3	5.4	5.7	5.8	6.2	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short Term	592.4	18819	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.5	9.15
***** Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Term	1666.0	666	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.5	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short-Term	1413.0	2066	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.4	11.75
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Term	16.4	4180	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.8	6.9	6.3	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Term	1461.7	3628	0.3	0.1	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.9	15974	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.3	8.04
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Term	4339.2	12447	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.2	19.81
*** Axis Ultra Short Term	15.8	6074	1.1	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.5	5.9	10.15
*** DSP Ultra Short Term	3656.8	4599	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.9	6.54
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.3	17465	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.9	6.2	9.03
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Term	2904.8	1497	0.7	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.1	4.68
*** Kotak Ultra Short Term	46.1	15962	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	6.1	7.15
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Term	1481.9	222	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.2	2.03
*** SBI Ultra Short Term	6440.9	11880	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	6.3	10.96
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.2	6495	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.6	5.9	9.97
*** UTI Ultra Short Term	4555.2	3348	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.7	6.3	11.61
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Term	1460.5	584	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.3	6.4	5.7	-
*** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3395.1	184	0.9	0.4	6.0	6.4	6.4	5.8	-
*** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4077.6	582	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.7	-
*** LIC MF Ultra Short Term	1417.0	678	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.3	6.4	5.7	2.26
*** PGIM India Ultra Short Term	36.5	211	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.2	6.4	5.8	-
*** ITI Ultra Short Term	1323.5	165	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.1	6.2	5.5	-
*** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.6	524	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.7	5.1	-
*** Sundaram Ultra Short Term	2862.7	2416	1.3	0.2	5.3	5.8	6.0	5.4	1.28

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TO SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short to ST	587.1	21047	0.5	0.4	6.2	7.1	7.3	6.5	6.09
***** UTI Ultra Short to ST	3824.3	2680	0.4	0.3	6.1	6.9	7.1	6.9	7.12
***** Axis Ultra Short to ST	3331.0	4558	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.9	7.1	6.3	7.59
***** Bandhan Ultra Short to ST	41.4	6404	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.8	6.1	-
***** HDFC Ultra Short to ST	61.9	17793	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.5	6.7	6.1	11.75

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

★★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short to ST	30.8	875	0.8	0.3	5.9	7.4	7.3	6.4	7.56
★★★★★	ABSL Ultra Short to ST	701.3	9727	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.3	6.5	5.9	7.94
★★★★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short to ST	45.4	1111	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
★★★★★	DSP Ultra Short to ST	21.3	4750	0.5	0.3	5.6	6.6	6.8	6.1	-
★★★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short to ST	4061.9	1833	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.9	6.1	7.20
★★★★★	JM Ultra Short to ST	39.8	215	0.7	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.8	6.0	3.48
★★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short to ST	2421.8	2434	0.7	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.7	5.9	6.15
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short to ST	4020.2	7933	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.8	6.1	5.09
★★★★★	Tata Ultra Short to ST	4229.4	2871	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.2	4.04
★★★★★	Kotak Ultra Short to ST	3578.1	12093	1.0	0.3	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.9	8.77
★★★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short to ST	42.5	2010	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.9	5.21
★★★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short to ST	1751.4	535	0.9	0.3	5.6	6.4	6.6	5.8	12.86
★★★★★	SBI Ultra Short to ST	3739.4	11622	0.8	0.4	5.5	6.4	6.7	6.0	4.62
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Shrt to ST	42.9	382	0.9	0.2	5.5	6.4	6.5	5.8	-
★★★★★	Sundaram Ultra Short to ST	3694.0	446	1.0	0.3	5.2	6.2	6.5	5.8	1.42

Aluminium extrusion units hit by supply chain disruption

WAR EFFECT. Output down to 30% of 30 lt capacity; face closure as costs soar

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Aluminium extrusion units are facing the threat of closure and further job losses with production falling sharply post the Iran war, leaving manufacturers operating at 27-30 per cent of their installed capacity, according to the Aluminium Extrusion Manufacturers Association of India (ALEMAI).

Production has declined to 8-9 lakh tonnes from around 12 lakh tonnes earlier against an installed capacity of about 30 lakh tonnes. This means capacity utilisation has fallen from roughly 40 per cent to 27-30 per cent, said Jitendra Chopra, President, ALEMAI. “If the government does not act soon, we will



have to lock our factories and hand over the keys to banks,” added Chopra who was in Gandhinagar for inauguration of ‘Aluminium Bharat’ exhibition.

Chopra attributed the decline to supply-chain disruptions, energy costs and expensive raw materials. He said aluminium product imports have risen to 15-16 lakh tonnes, significantly exceeding local production. “When we are importing

15-16 lakh tonnes which is double our production, then we are literally turning into a trading hub,” he said.

REMOVE DUTY

The industry is seeking removal of the 7.5 per cent basic Customs duty on primary aluminium, arguing that it raises the raw-material cost for domestic downstream manufacturers.

The Cable and Conductor Manufacturers Association of India (CACMAI) and the Aluminium Secondary Manufacturers Association (ASMA) said LME prices have risen from around \$2,200 a tonne to over \$3,700, while several other inputs have become pricier by 20-35 per cent over the past three months.

A 10 per cent social welfare surcharge on the import duty, takes the effective

duty to 8.25 per cent, the Associations said. They argue that domestic aluminium is generally priced at international and import-parity levels, meaning downstream manufacturers bear the duty burden even when sourcing locally.

The squeeze is also showing in employment and working capital. “Job losses are happening, we are facing problems getting access to working capital. Orders have dropped. In the last one year 30 per cent of the manpower has been slashed,” Chopra said.

CACMAI said Gujarat has nearly 100 aluminium extrusion units across Rajkot, Ahmedabad, Vadodara, Surat and Morbi, serving sectors including automobiles, engineering, construction, power and RE sectors.

NTPC, France’s EDF in clean energy tie-up; focus on nuclear power

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India and France on Friday discussed deepening co-operation in non-fossil fuel sources, including nuclear power, with state-run NTPC signing a 50:50 joint venture (JV) agreement with EDF Power Solutions India to develop, own and operate clean energy projects in the Indian sub-continent.

The JV firm, with the Indian arm of French power major EDF, is eyeing pumped storage, hydro power, and other renewable energy projects as also distribution within India and neighbouring countries. The MoU was signed in the presence of NTPC CMD Gurdeep Singh and EDF Chairman and CEO Bernard Fontana.

NUCLEAR POWER

The agreement was part of a larger meeting between India and France with Power Secretary Pankaj Agarwal, and Fontana reviewing the ongoing engagement between India and EDF on the proposed deployment of European Pressurised Reactors (EPRs) in India.

The meeting was attended by officials from the Ministries of Power and External Affairs as also from the Central Electricity Authority, NTPC and Nuclear Power Corporation of India, and representatives of EDF

and the French Embassy in India.

The discussions centred on the deployment of EPR technology, India’s regulatory reforms for the nuclear sector, cooperation on pumped hydro storage projects, and the way forward for a robust, mutually beneficial partnership.

NEW REGULATIONS

Agarwal briefed the French side on the progress made in finalising India’s regulatory framework for the nuclear power sector, including the draft SHANTI (Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India) Rules and Regulations, placed by the Department of Atomic Energy in the public domain for stakeholder consultation.

The Rules provide for a streamlined, time-bound licensing framework and enable participation of private and foreign partners in India’s nuclear power programme. In April, NTPC and EDF had signed a Non-Binding MoU to explore cooperation in developing new nuclear power projects in India.

The MoU established a framework for both companies to jointly assess the feasibility and approach for collaboration, including understanding EDF’s EPR technology and its suitability for Indian requirements and providing technical support as mutually agreed.

SWELECT rolls out new inverters for industrial use

Our Bureau
Chennai

Chennai-based SWELECT Energy Systems Ltd is rolling out its SWEES EN+ hybrid inverter range for Commercial and Industrial (C&I) customers.

The range, available from 5 kW to 50 kW, is designed around energy storage needs of businesses.

SWEES EN+ manages solar generation, battery storage and grid supply through a single system.

“With the BIS certification for our hybrid inverters, we are now rolling out the SWEES EN+ range from 5 kW to 50 kW, with a strong focus on the evolving energy requirements of C&I customers. The range has been designed with scalability at its core, enabling solutions to be configured in line with varying load profiles, operational requirements and future energy needs,” said Arulkumar Shanmugasundaram, CEO and Managing Director, SWELECT Energy Systems Ltd.

In 2nd listing bid, Anmol Ind files for ₹1,800 crore ‘OFS-only’ IPO

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Biscuit-maker Anmol Industries has filed draft papers with market regulator SEBI for an initial public offering of up to ₹1,800 crore.

The proposed public offer of the Kolkata-based branded packaged foods company, the fourth-largest biscuits brand in India by sales value, will be entirely an offer for sale (OFS) with the promoter selling shares, with no fresh issue component.

This is Anmol Industries’ second attempt to tap the public market. The company had filed a draft red herring prospectus with the regulator in June 2018 for an IPO comprising an OFS of up to ₹750 crore, but did not go ahead with the plan.

BOOK-BUILDING ROUTE

According to the DRHP filed on Friday, the IPO, with a face value of ₹5, will be an OFS for equity shares up to ₹1,800 crore by promoter Bajinath Choudhary



& Family Trust.

The offer is being made through the book-building process, wherein not more than 50 per cent of the net offer is allocated to qualified institutional buyers, and not less than 15 per cent and 35 per cent of the net offer is assigned to non-institutional bidders and retail individual bidders, respectively.

The Kolkata-based company, which operates in the packaged biscuits, cakes and bakery products market, competes with Britannia Industries, Parle Products, ITC, Mrs. Bector’s Food Specialties and Mondelez India Foods, among others.

The company has a broad geographic presence across India, with its products

available in 4,266 pincodes across 24 States and two Union Territories. It also exports to 31 countries.

7 FACTORIES

As of the date of this draft red herring prospectus, the biscuit maker operates a network of seven manufacturing facilities located across key regions including Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal and Odisha. Its manufacturing facilities have an aggregate installed capacity of around 3.61 lakh tonne per annum for biscuits and cookies, and 16,372 mtpa for cakes as of March 31, 2026.

Anmol Industries’ revenue from operations and net profit were ₹2,101.8 crore and ₹190.9 crore, respectively, during the last financial year.

ICICI Securities, IIFL Capital Services and Intensive Fiscal Services are the book-running lead managers for the initial public offering. The equity shares of the company are proposed to be listed on the National Stock Exchange of India and BSE.

IIT Madras Unicorn Frontier Fund I achieves first close, raising ₹450 cr; targets ₹1,000 crore by Dec

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

IIT Madras, IIT Madras Research Park (IITMRP), and venture capital firm Unicorn India Ventures have achieved the first close of their ₹1,000 crore deep tech Unicorn Frontier Fund, mopping up ₹450 crore.

The first close has been achieved in just about three months after receiving SEBI’s approval to launch the fund. IITM RP is confident of achieving final close by December, given the interest it has seen.

The Fund announced the first close in the presence of Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at an event on Saturday in Bengaluru.

3 KEY CONTRIBUTORS

Natarajan Malupillai, Group CEO, IITM Research Park, Incubation Cell & RTBI, told *businessline* that the fund has been raised from broadly three stakeholders: IIT-M alumni both in India and



The IIT M deep tech Fund announced the first close in the presence of Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at an event in Bengaluru on Saturday

abroad; clients of the Research Park ecosystem itself, and, third, some of the banking/financial institutions and family offices.

“I expect it will be between ₹800-1,000 crore by the time we’ve officially closed the fund,” he said, adding that sovereign and institutional capital will play a bigger part in the next phase, with advanced discussions underway with entities such as SIDBI and the government’s RDI Fund ecosystem. IITM RP considers the strong alumni response as an

indication of the ecosystem’s desire to participate more directly in India’s growth and deep-tech story. “Now that we have our own fund, it made their participation more tangible and personal than investing in a conventional large fund,” he added.

While start-ups part of the IIT Madras incubation cell will be under the radar of the new Fund, it will also consider start-ups from outside the ecosystem working on strategically important/frontier technologies. The fund also announced

already deploying nearly ₹55 crore in 4 deep tech start-ups including Hathor, Quanstra, Triolt Energy, and Carbelim.

KEY FOCUS SECTORS

Space, defence, semiconductors, advanced AI, IoT and sensors, industrial automation, health tech, biotech, climate tech and EV/mobility are among a few focus sectors.

There is no strict company-age criterion, but start-ups should have a validated product, be beyond TRL 4, Malupillai said. “By 2030 or 2032, we want a steady state deep tech IPOs coming out of this Fund; we need to get them to ₹1,000 crore+ revenue type models... that is really the focus,” he said.

Bhaskar Majumdar, Managing Partner, Unicorn India Ventures, said, “Through our partnership with IIT Madras, we aim to provide early founders the capital and strategic support required to scale and build globally competitive companies from India.”

₹2,300-cr e-methanol plant in Gujarat to develop Kandla port as a green-fuel and bunkering hub

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The Deendayal Port Authority (DPA) and Assam Petro-Chemicals Ltd (APCL) on Saturday laid the foundation stone for a 150 tonnes-per-day (TPD) e-methanol plant at Gandhidham, in a project estimated to cost ₹2,300 crore and expected to create more than 3,500 direct and indirect jobs.

The facility, being developed as a joint venture between DPA and APCL, is aimed at supplying cleaner fuel to the maritime sector and is part of Kandla’s larger plan to develop itself as a green-fuel and bunkering hub. The foundation stone was laid at Gandhidham in the presence of Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, and Union Ports, Shipping and Waterways Minister Sarbananda Sonowal.

The plant will produce 150 tonnes of

e-methanol a day. The project is expected to support the development of a wider ecosystem covering production, storage, handling and bunkering of green fuels at Kandla Port.

In January, DPA and APCL had signed an MoU for the 150-TPD facility, with the investment then pegged at ₹1,200 crore. The latest announcement puts the project cost at about ₹2,300 crore.

businessline had first reported about Kandla’s larger green fuel plan in August 2025. The report said DPA was looking to position Kandla as a bunkering hub for methanol-fuelled ships and was exploring an e-methanol project with an estimated investment of about ₹3,500 crore and much larger proposed production capacity.

The 150-TPD project now being taken forward is smaller than the capacity envisaged in the earlier proposal, but forms part of the same broader strategy to develop Kandla as a green-

fuel hub. DPA has been working on building infrastructure for the transition towards cleaner marine fuels. The port’s green-energy plans include facilities for green hydrogen, bio-methanol and e-methanol, alongside infrastructure for storage and bunkering. For Kandla, the objective goes beyond producing e-methanol. The port wants to establish an ecosystem that can eventually allow ships calling at the port to access alternative marine fuels, helping reduce the shipping sector’s dependence on conventional fossil fuels.

Gujarat CM Bhupendra Patel said the project would strengthen Kandla’s role in India’s green-energy transition and support the development of green shipping infrastructure. He said Deendayal Port was being developed as a green-hydrogen hub under the National Green Hydrogen Mission, with an ecosystem for the production, storage, handling and transportation of green hydrogen and its derivatives.

India’s net FDI receipts rose to five-year high of \$7.3 b in July; outward flow up, too

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Net Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) at \$7.3 billion in July was the highest monthly flow in five years, reflecting robust gross inflows of \$14.6 billion, according to the RBI. Net FDI in June 2026 stood at \$ 1.3 billion.

“FDI flows strengthened further in July, supported by robust gross inflows. Communication, financial and computer services were the ma-

ajor sectors receiving more than four-fifths of the equity inflows,” central bank officials said in the article *State of the Economy*, published in the RBI’s latest Monthly Bulletin.

Mauritius, the UAE, and the US were the major source countries, accounting for about 70 per cent of equity inflows.

During April-July 2026, net FDI and gross FDI inflows were higher at \$13.4 billion and \$43.9 billion, respectively, compared to \$9.7 billion and \$38.9 billion in the corresponding period last year.

RBI officials noted that overseas investments also rose during July after declining for two consecutive months.

More than two-thirds of outward FDI flows went to Singapore, the UK, and the UAE.

OUTWARD FDI

The major sectors witnessing outward FDI were financial, insurance and business services, and manufacturing — together accounting for about two-thirds of the outward flows.

Cabinet panel clears ₹17,167 cr Thoothukudi outer harbour project

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) has approved the ₹17,167-crore Outer Harbour Project at VO Chidambaranar Port in Thoothukudi. This is a significant step in expanding the port’s maritime infrastructure and strengthening Thoothukudi’s long-term role in India’s trade and connectivity.

The project will create major new harbour infrastructure and container terminal capacity, laying the foundation for the next phase of growth at VOC Port, said the port authority.

The harbour infrastructure project will be taken up under the Hybrid Annuity Model at a cost of ₹11,733 crore, and the container terminal (phase I and II) worth ₹5,434 crore will be taken up under the Design-Build-Finance-Operate-Transfer model, according to the VOC Port Authority.

E-2W industry well-established, does not need sops: Ather CBO

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Electric two-wheeler-maker Ather Energy has said that the EV industry is now established and so the market can do without subsidies such as the Prime Minister Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PME E-DRIVE).

Many State governments are also giving subsidies from their side so the sales can even do without the Centre’s subsidies, Ravneet S Phokela, Chief Business Officer, Ather Energy, told *businessline*.

“In any case this (PM E-DRIVE) was supposed to go away last year. We had planned for it not to be there. It’s just that the government has extended it given the tailwind that it was seeing for just last one push. So, the industry had anyway modelled not getting it in their financials as had we... the industry is in stage where you don’t need subsidies to be self-sustaining... the only ask that we have is that the policies such that it provides a level playing field for every kind of player,” Phokela said.

He explained that the schemes such as PM E-DRIVE is same for every original equipment manufacturer (OEM), that is passed onto the customers. But on the suppliers side there is the production linked incentive (PLI) scheme, where some players have, but some don’t and that’s been a challenge where companies have said that there should be an equal opportunity for all, which is not yet the case.



Ravneet S Phokela, Chief Business Officer, Ather Energy

Phokela said Ather Energy was going through excess demand with 50-60 per cent of the bookings in waiting period of 45-50 days because of production constraints in its factory in Tamil Nadu. This factory has a capacity of 30,000-35,000 units a month, and the new plant in Maharashtra, which will start production from December, would help it meet the demand. The new unit expects to roll out around 42,000 units a month. So, Ather will produce around 77,000 units a month by early next year.

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